The Corporation of the Town of Ajax

GENERAL GOVERNMENT COMMITTEE

Monday, March 20, 2023
Open Meeting at 1:00 p.m.
Closed Session to follow immediately after open session
Electronic Meeting
65 Harwood Avenue South

AGENDA

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Electronic Meeting: In-person attendance is not permitted at this meeting of the General Government Committee. This meeting will be livestreamed for viewing at ajax.ca/live. Electronic participation is permitted pursuant to the Municipal Act and Council's Procedure By-law.

Online Agenda: Anything in **blue** denotes an attachment/link. By clicking the links on the agenda page, you can jump directly to that section of the agenda.

J. Dies, Chair
L. Bower, Vice Chair

Open Meeting

1. Call To Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 **2023 Operating Budget and 2023 Capital Budget; 2024 – 2032 Long Range Capital Forecast Meeting – February 16, 2023** 4

3.2 **Regular Meeting – February 21, 2023** 15

3.3 **Closed Session Meeting – February 21, 2023** ..... (circulated separately)
- *Any discussion will be held in the Closed Session*

4. Consent Agenda – *Considered to be routine, these items may be approved by one motion. Items may be separated and referred to the Discussion Agenda*

4.1 **CAO-2023-02: Council Ward Constituent Newsletter Update**
S. Baker, Chief Administrative Officer / D. Jarvis, Supervisor of Communications & Engagement 20

4.2 **CAO-2023-03: Vaccination Policy**
S. Baker, Chief Administrative Officer / M. Cosentino, Manager of Human Resource Services 28

4.3 **CAO-2023-04: OMERS By-law**
S. Baker, Chief Administrative Officer / M. Cosentino, Manager of Human Resource Services 40

4.4 **FIN-2023-06: 2022 Statement of Remuneration and Expenses for Members of Council and Council Appointees**
D. Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer / S. Webster, Financial Analyst 47

4.5 **OES-2023-09: Contract Award – AVL & Dashcams Award**
D. Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services / C. Walker, Manager of Innovation & Technology 55

4.6 **OES-2023-01: Contract Award – Ajax Cricket Site Improvements**
D. Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services / L. Sinclair, Supervisor of Facility Capital Projects & Asset Management 62

4.7 **OES-2023-05: RFT No. T23003 – Municipal Vehicles – Brine Truck with Snowplow**
D. Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services / D. Quigley, Interim Supervisor of Fleet and Inventory Services 69

4.8 **PDS-2023-06: Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics – Implementation Update**
G. Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services / C. Richardson, Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change 73

4.9 **PDS-2023-07: Pickering Village Community Improvement Plan: 2022 Façade Improvement Grant and Sign Grant Program Summary**
G. Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services / M. Sawchuck, Senior Planner 82

4.10 **PDS-2023-08: 2022 Year End Building Permit Activity and 2023 Projection Report**
G. Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services / S. McReelis, Manager of Building Approvals/Chief Building Official 91

4.11 **PDS-2023-09: Development Charge Deferral Amending Agreement – 35-37 Kings Crescent**
G. Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services / S. McReelis, Manager of Building Approvals/Chief Building Official 96

5. Discussion

None

6. Presentations

6.1 **PDS-2023-05: Environmental Sustainability Projects and Programs – Status Update**
G. Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services / C. Richardson, Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change 101

Closed Session

7. Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session

7.1 Elexicon Corp Strategic Update

- *A matter pertaining to a trade secret or scientific, technical, commercial, financial or labour relations information, supplied in confidence to the municipality or local board, which, if disclosed, could reasonably be expected to prejudice significantly the competitive position or interfere significantly with the contractual or other negotiations of a person, group of persons, or organization negotiations [Sec. 239 (2)(i), Municipal Act, 2001, as amended];*
- *A matter pertaining to a trade secret or scientific, technical, commercial or financial information that belongs to the municipality or local board and has monetary value or potential monetary value [Sec. 239 (2)(j), Municipal Act, 2001, as amended]; and*
- *A matter pertaining to a position, plan, procedure, criteria or instruction to be applied to any negotiations carried on or to be carried on by or on behalf of the municipality or local board [Sec. 239 (2)(k), Municipal Act, 2001, as amended]*

7.2 Fire Service Dispatch Negotiations

- *To discuss labour relations or employee negotiations [Sec. 239 (2)(d), Municipal Act, 2001, as amended]*

8. Adjournment

DRAFT Minutes of the General Government Committee Meeting 2023 Operating Budget and 2023 Capital Budget; 2024-2032 Long Range Capital Forecast Held Electronically at 9:00 a.m. on February 16, 2023

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accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair – Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Chair – Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 9:00 a.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Mayor's Opening Comments

Mayor Collier, Budget Chair, provided opening comments, thanked staff for their hard work on the preparation of the 2023 Operating Budget and 2023 Capital Budget; 2024 – 2032 Long Range Capital Forecast, and reviewed highlights of the proposed budget.

4. Reports Requiring Direction

4.1 **FIN-2023-02: Capital Reserve Status Report**

Committee Members asked questions regarding the Town's building portfolio namely facility usage and condition, building naming rights eligibility, opportunities to utilize existing infrastructure to assist the unhoused population, status of the review of underutilized Town facilities and building appraisals, debenture financing and leasing options for vehicle and equipment, and remedies to address the infrastructure funding gap. Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, Kassandra Cruciano, Senior Advisor, Grants, Partnerships & Strategic Initiatives, Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, Samuel Twumasi, Manager of Economic Development, and Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Move by: L. Bower

That Council approve the implementation of a 2% infrastructure levy in the 2023 Operating Budget.

CARRIED

4.2 **PDS-2023-03: Stormwater Funding Implementation Strategy**

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for a proposed flat fee vs. a mill rate, objective of a stormwater management system, stormwater funding, and stormwater-related charges among other municipalities. D. Valentim, G. Romanowski, and Stephen Ruddy, Manager of Development Engineering, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council approve the Stormwater Funding Implementation Strategy as outlined in this report, and

2. That Staff develop, in consultation with non-residential stakeholders, a Stormwater Fee Credit Policy to be implemented concurrently with the Stormwater Fee.

CARRIED

5. Capital Budget

5.1 Capital Budget Presentation

D. Valentim delivered a presentation on the 2023 Capital Budget and 2024 – 2032 Long Range Capital Forecast.

D. Valentim provided an overview of the Town's capital budget and 2024– 2032 long range capital forecast and discussed process/timelines, capital budget funding, the Financial Sustainability Plan, and capital reserve allocations. D. Valentim reviewed the 2023 Draft Capital Budget including capital project funding, capital budget considerations, project numbering, capital project maps, capital budget reserve assumptions, stormwater reserve user fees, Canada Community-Building Fund details, and concluded the presentation with a review of multi-year/pre-budget approval projects and the new infrastructure levy.

Committee Members asked questions regarding the sustainability of the Canada Community-Building Fund given increased use in electric vehicles and inquired about the status of the Library report. D. Valentim and Sarah Vaisler, Chief Librarian and Executive Officer, responded to questions from Committee Members. D. Valentim noted that the Ajax Public Library Grant is covered under the operating budget.

5.2 Review of Budget

5.2.2. 2023 Capital Budget; 2024 – 2032 Long Range Capital Forecast

Chair Collier led the Committee through a section-by-section review of the proposed 2023 Capital Budget and 2024 – Long Range Capital Forecast. Questions and discussion focused primarily upon the following projects:

Project List

Studies and Other Initiatives

24000701 Traffic Calming Warrant Update 2025

Committee Members asked questions regarding project scope, timelines, and current traffic calming measures. G. Romanowski and Dhaval Pandya, Manager of Transportation Planning, responded to questions from Committee Members. G. Romanowski reviewed ongoing measures to support traffic calming.

23090101 Official Plan Review

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for increased project costs, project timelines and requirements under the Planning Act, opportunities to accelerate the Official Plan (OP) Review, project scope, and if the proposed business plans will accelerate the OP Review. Stev Andis, Manager of Planning and G. Romanowski, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Technology

23001801 Human Resource Mgmt System (HRMS)

Committee Members asked questions regarding increased project costs, project scope, benefits to the organization, popularity of a similar system among other private or public organizations, scope of the Customer Relationship Management System project, IT Strategy framework, and opportunities for revenue savings and efficiencies. Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Clerk, Chris Walker, Manager of Technology & Innovation, and D. Valentim, responded

to questions from Committee Members. C. Walker provided an overview of the system, noting that the centralized system would be leveraged by all Business Departments and that the project was identified as part of the IT Strategic Plan.

23003801 Radio System Hardware Upgrade

Committee Members asked questions regarding project scope, project rationale, project costs, coordination with NextGen Radio System, and if the system upgrade was identified in the Fire Master Plan. Aaron Burridge, Interim Fire Chief, responded to questions from Committee Members.

23010306 OLA Replacement

Committee Members asked questions regarding project rationale, content housed on OLA, project alignment with the new HRMS, and project timelines, noting that the project was not forecasted historically. Devon Jarvis, Supervisor of Communications & Engagement and C. Walker, responded to questions from Committee Members. D. Jarvis noted that the current Intranet site is outdated and highlighted inadequacies of the current Intranet platform.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Lee

That capital project 23010306: OLA Replacement be deferred to 2024 for consideration in future capital budgets.

CARRIED

23010301 JDE Upgrade

Committee Members asked questions regarding project scope and opportunities for integration with HRMS. C. Walker responded to questions from Committee Members.

26010302 Anti Virus (EDR) Software Upgrade
27010301 Firewall Upgrade

Committee Members asked questions regarding upgrade frequency and technology infrastructure management processes. C. Walker and D. Valentim, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Town Buildings

23000401 Rotary Park Pavilion - Feasibility Study
25000301 St. Andrews Feasibility Study – RPMP

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for the studies, scope of work to be completed under the Recreation & Parks Master Plan and the Waterfront Management Plan, project timelines, capital budget allocation for Pickering Village Arena, timelines associated with a Request for Proposal (RFP) for the Pickering Village Arena site, status of improvements to St. Andrews Community Centre, construction timelines, and seniors centre models. D. Meredith and Chris Vida, Director of Recreation & Culture, responded to questions from Committee Members.

23000301 Demo-Greenwood House/Barn/Flats/Washrm

Committee Members expressed concerns regarding project costs given that the Town does not own the property or the building. Committee Members asked questions regarding opportunities for additional parking at Greenwood House and opportunities to offload the facility to the Region of Durham. D. Meredith noted that the Town owns the building, and reviewed project scope and rationale.

23070402 MCC Community Room 2 Renovations

Committee Members sought clarification regarding which room is Community Room 2 and questioned the necessary timing of the project this year, noting that it was not forecasted historically. C. Vida noted that Community Room 1 is offline and unavailable for Town programming or rental.

23070901 Roof Repl Rotary Park, Hartrick and Quaker

Committee Members asked questions regarding project costs, infrastructure impacts resulting from deferred maintenance, opportunities to separate the projects, discretionary funds, and project timelines. D. Meredith and C. Vida, responded to questions from Committee Members. D. Valentim noted that the Town can fund emergency repairs but noted that this process does not support good procurement practices.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That capital project 23070901 Roof Repl Rotary Park, Hartrick and Quaker be deferred to 2024 for consideration in future capital budgets pending the completion of appraisals and various related studies.

MOTION LOST

24001501 Fire HQ - Outdoor Training Shelter

Committee Members asked questions regarding project scope and opportunities for a shared training shelter throughout Durham Region. Interim Fire Chief Burridge responded to questions from Committee Members.

23070303 ACC Main Lobby Elevator Refurbishment
24000301 ACC Rec Master Plan Renovation

Committee Members expressed concerns related to accessibility issues and barriers. Committee Members asked questions regarding project costs, project timelines, opportunities to secure a new building rather than renovating the existing facility, and feasibility of ongoing facility maintenance. C. Vida and D. Meredith, responded to questions from Committee Members.

31000201 Operation Centre - Curtain Wall Upgrades

Committee Members asked questions regarding project scope and rationale. D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members.

23010101 Town Hall Service & Parking Lot Rehab

Committee Members expressed concerns regarding parking lot design namely obstructed views and asked if a concept plan is coming forward. D. Meredith discussed components of the project and highlighted speeding and accessibility issues.

23090202 Fire Station 2 Renovations (FMP)

Committee Members asked questions regarding costs associated with a new facility vs. renovating the existing facility, project timelines, projected cost increases, sustainability, and capital funding options namely opportunities to debenture the project. Interim Fire Chief Burridge, D. Meredith, and D. Valentim, responded to questions from Committee Members. D. Valentim noted that the project is funded through development charges.

Parks & Open Spaces

23070009 Cedar Park Batting Cage

Committee Members expressed concerns regarding project costs and asked questions regarding project scope, project demand, revenue generation, proposed location and highway 401 corridor impacts, and cost-effective project alternatives. D. Meredith provided rationale for increased project costs, and discussed project scope and project timelines.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Lee

That capital project 230070009 - Cedar Park Batting Cage be deferred to 2026 for consideration in future capital budgets.

MOTION LOST

1029711 Meadows North Neigh Park

Committee Members asked questions regarding project scope, project funding, location, and opportunities to bring in servicing infrastructure to accommodate a waterpark. D. Valentim noted that the project is funded through development charges. D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members.

23000801 North Ajax - Cricket Infrastructure

Committee Members asked questions regarding project completion timelines and project costs. D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members.

Committee recessed at 12:20 p.m.

Committee resumed at 1:00 p.m.

23070005 Exeter Park – Park Retrofit
1036311 Millers Creek Trail (MCC) Rec
1036111 Trail Recon – Hermitage Park

Committee Members sought rationale for the retrofits and project timelines. D. Meredith provided rationale for the retrofits and identified maintenance and repair priorities.

Committee Members asked staff to include detail sheets for all capital projects in the future to provide additional context.

Vehicles & Equipment

23003001 Multi-use Tractor with Implements
23090305 Articulated/Sidewalk Tractor w/Brine/Plow
23003101 Blvd Grounds Maint Equip-pend new staff appr

Committee Members expressed concerns regarding procurement costs. Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for the equipment purchases, equipment functions, and staff resources. D. Meredith provided rationale for procurement of the equipment noting that additional resources are required to assist with winter control operations. D. Meredith noted that the equipment has already received pre-budget approval.

23090501 Library Collection - Growth – 2023

Committee Members asked why this item is included in the capital budget rather than the Library Grant. D. Valentim noted that the project is funded through development charges.

23000701 Bike Counters

Committee Members asked questions regarding project rationale. G. Romanowski noted that bike counters are recommended under the Town's Integrated Transportation Master Plan and the Town could be eligible for future grant funding.

23070112 Holiday Decorations 2023

Committee Members asked questions regarding project costs, life cycle, and display period. D. Meredith noted that some of the decorations have exceeded their life cycle and require replacement.

23070205 ACC Floor Machines

Committee Members sought clarification regarding the number of floor machines being procured. C. Vida noted that the floor machines have exceeded their life cycle and require replacement.

Committee Members sought rationale for why there isn't a detail sheet for each capital project. D. Valentim and S. Baker noted that staff will look to improve the budget process for next year.

23002301 Accommodation Strategy-Workstation Modification

Committee Members asked questions regarding project rationale, project scope, proposed work model, impacts if the project is deferred to 2024, opportunities to separate the project into phases, furniture disposal and recycling options, scope of work to be completed in the Office of the CAO, funding, and accommodation needs for employees working remotely. D. Valentim, K. Cruciano, G. Romanowski, S. Baker, and N. Cooper, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Road Network

23003601 Harwood MUP - Falby Ct. to Clover Ridge Dr.
23090312 Harwood Bike Lane - Falby to Westney
23090313 Harwood (E Side) MUT - Bayly to Falby

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for the phased project approach, rationale for inclusion of on-road bike lanes and a multi-use path along the Harwood corridor, detailed design, increased costs, and timelines associated with the implementation of cycling infrastructure in North Ajax. G. Romanowski and D. Meredith, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Mayor Collier noted that Council passed a motion in October 2021 directing staff to proceed with detailed design of an off-road multi-use path (on the east side of Harwood Avenue) instead of the proposed on-road active transportation facilities as recommended in the 2012 Lower Harwood Study and 2019 Integrated Transportation Master Plan.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That capital project 23090312 Harwood Bike Lane – Falby to Westney be removed from the capital budget.

CARRIED

23090320 Harwood (W Side) Bike Lane-Bayly to Falby

Committee Members asked if this segment is associated with project 23090313 Harwood (E Side) MUT - Bayly to Falby. G. Romanowski responded to the question from Committee Members.

23090318 Stannardville Bike Lane - Rossland to Hurst
23090319 Hurst Bike Lane - Stannardville to Church

Committee Members sought clarification on the necessary timing of the projects this year. D. Valentim noted that the projects are funded through development charges. G. Romanowski provided rationale for timing of the projects.

1029011 Rossland Wide Salem/LakeRidge
1028611 Rossland Wide Westney-Salem

Committee Members asked questions regarding funding sources, project status, project timelines, timelines associated with the tendering process and land acquisition process, detailed design, and funding sources. D. Meredith noted that the detailed design has been awarded for Rossland Road from Westney Road to Lake Ridge Road. D. Meredith, G. Romanowski, and D. Valentim, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Traffic Signal Light Replacements

Committee Members sought clarification regarding who is responsible for traffic signal light replacements. D. Meredith advised that unwarranted signals are the responsibility of the lower tier municipality.

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Bridges & Culverts

23030402 Municipal Bridge Inspections

Committee Members asked if municipal bridge inspections are part of the asset allocation study. D. Meredith noted that it is a legislative requirement to inspect bridges and culverts every two (2) years.

Stormwater Network

23001401 Waterfront Rain Garden – Construction

Committee Members sought clarification on the necessary timing of the project this year. S. Ruddy responded to the question from Committee Members. D. Valentim noted that the project is funded through the Canada Community-Build Fund.

Summary of New Capital Projects by Driver

Committee Members had no comments or questions on this section of the capital budget document.

Financing Summaries

Committee Members had no comments or questions on this section of the capital budget document.

Continuity Schedules

Committee Members had no comments or questions on this section of the capital budget document.

5.3 **Public Comments & Questions**

Chair Collier invited comments and questions from the public on the proposed 2023 Capital Budget and 2024 **–** 2032 Long Range Capital Forecast.

There were no questions or comments from the public.

Committee Members and Chair Collier thanked staff for their hard work in preparing the 2023 Capital Budget and 2024-2032 Long Range Capital Forecast.

5.2 **Review of Budget**

5.2.1. **FIN-2023-03: 2023 Capital Budget; 2024 – 2032 Long Range Capital Forecast**

Final Recommendations, as Amended:

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

1. That the following 2023 General Levy Funded Reserve Allocations be approved:

Reserve	
Building Maintenance	$889,700
Election	81,000
Post Build Out	113,300
Development	200,000
Strategic Initiatives	387,000
Roads Maintenance	1,815,300
General Infrastructure Maintenance	973,300
Vehicle and Equipment	1,657,900
Total Allocations	**$6,117,500**

2. That the 2023 Capital Budget in the amount of $28,670,900 be approved, as amended;

3. That revenue collected from the new Stormwater User Fee in the estimated amount of $2,670,000 be transferred to the Stormwater Maintenance Reserve;

4. That the 2024 – 2032 Long Range Capital Forecast be received for information.

CARRIED

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Henry, Councillor Tyler Morin, Mayor Collier

Opposed: None

Committee recessed at 3:04 p.m.

Committee resumed at 3:21 p.m.

6. Operating Budget

6.1 Operating Budget Presentation

D. Valentim delivered a presentation on the 2023 Operating Budget.

D. Valentim provided an overview of the Town's operating budget including process and timelines for development of the budget. D. Valentim discussed the budget framework, operating budget overview, the Library Grant, operating budget impacts and pressures, Public Health Reserve, stormwater fee impacts on the residential tax bill, Bill 23, More Homes Built Faster Act, 2022 impacts, expenditures by source, revenues by source, operating budget outlook, and tax calculation.

Committee Members asked questions regarding the portion of taxation revenues and impacts to residents on the property tax bill. D. Valentim responded to questions from Committee Members. S. Baker noted that the Town looks to increase non-tax revenues year over year to ease the tax burden.

6.2 Review of Budget

6.2.2. 2023 Operating Budget

Chair Collier led the Committee through a section-by-section review of the proposed 2023 Operating Budget.

Section 3: Business Cases

Digital Graphic Designer

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for the cost / benefit analysis outlined in the business case. D. Jarvis provided an overview of costs associated with the position and noted that the salary also reflects current pay of the contract position.

Labour Relations Specialist

Committee Members asked if this position is currently a contracted position and asked questions regarding payroll administration and costs associated with contracted services vs. in-house services. Mary Lou Cosentino, Manager of HR Services and S. Baker, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Financial Analyst (Development Accounting)

Committee Members asked questions regarding future staffing needs to support development growth and if the position is exempt or non-exempt. D. Valentim and G. Romanowski, responded to questions from Committee Members.

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Summer Student – Finance

Committee Members asked questions regarding opportunities for grant funding or apprenticeship programs. D. Valentim and Christie McLardie, Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, responded to questions from Committee Members.

By-law Services Associate & Waterfront Admin Support

Committee Members sought clarification regarding rationale for the positions. N. Cooper provided justifications for the positions, noting that the parking enforcement and permitting programs generate non-tax revenues for the Town, which offset the cost of these programs and contribute to the recovery of the cost of the positions.

HRMS – Business Solutions Specialist

Committee Members asked if the position would contribute to payroll efficiencies. S. Baker responded to the question from Committee Members.

Environmental Service Workers – Special Events

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for the number of positions, costs, opportunities for portable stage rentals, and collective agreement restrictions. D. Meredith and D. Valentim, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Operations Technologist – Technical Services and Maintenance Contracts

Committee Members asked questions regarding customer service / engagement complaints, expected customer service benefits, and functions of the position. D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members.

Crossing Guard Supervisor

Committee Members asked questions regarding crossing guard shortages, crossing guard program costs, service delivery adopted by the City of Pickering, costs for contracted services, and portfolio and function of the position. D. Meredith responded to questions from Committee Members.

Fleet and Inventory Supervisor

Committee Members sought clarification regarding the necessary timing of the business case. D. Meredith provided rationale for the position and reviewed functions of the position.

Borehole & Geotechnical Reporting

Committee Members asked if this position was historically a contracted position and sought clarification regarding the business case. D. Meredith responded to the question from Committee Members, noting that the position is currently a contracted service.

PT Facility Booking Representative

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for the position, expanded service hours, revenue projections, and service levels. C. Vida reviewed the business case and noted that Town facilities are understaffed and overutilized.

Recreation Facilities – Contracted Security

Committee Members expressed concerns regarding costs associated with the business case. Committee Members asked questions regarding roving services, opportunities to share contracted security services with the Ajax Public Library, and limitations imposed on security guards. C. Vida reviewed expected benefits and service impacts. S. Vaisler noted that the Ajax Public Library partners with Recreation & Culture for security services when needed.

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Festivals & Events Coordinator

Committee Members asked if this is a new position. C. Vida responded to questions from Committee Members and noted that the position was pre-approved prior to the pandemic and has been re-introduced into the 2023 capital budget.

Energy & Sustainability Coordinator

Committee Members asked questions regarding justifications for the position. G. Romanowski and Cameron Richardson, Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change, provided rationale and justifications for the position.

Section 2: Department Summaries

Members provided questions and comments on the following sections within the proposed 2023 Operating Budget:

- **All Departments (p. 12):** Committee Members asked questions regarding Library surplus and the Library Reserve Policy namely allocation of surplus monies to the Town. S. Vaisler noted that the Library has not completed the 2022 year-end closing however estimates a forecasted surplus of $352,000. S. Vaisler further noted that surplus monies in excess of $250,000 are payable to the Town.

- **Mayor and Council (p.15):** Committee Members asked if the 'Mayor's HMS Ajax & River Plate Veterans Association visit to Normandy, France re: Anniversary of D-Day' is still scheduled given economic pressures. Mayor Collier noted that he will not be attending.

- **Finance (p.29):** Committee Members asked questions regarding staff resources in the Finance Department. D. Valentim provided a comparative analysis, reviewed functions of the Finance Department, and noted that the Finance Department supports growth across the organization.

- **Fire & Emergency Services – Administration (p.43):** Committee Members sought clarification regarding items that qualify as 'one-time purchases under $10,000'. Interim Fire Chief Burridge provided an explanation and examples.

- **Operational & Environmental Services - Environmental Services (p. 51)**: Committee Members asked questions regarding contract services. D. Meredith provided an overview of contracted services.

6.3 **Public Comments & Questions**

Chair Collier invited comments and questions from the public on the proposed 2023 Operating Budget.

There were no questions or comments from the public.

Committee Members and Chair Collier thanked staff for their hard work in preparing the 2023 Operating Budget.

6.2 **Review of Budget**

6.2.1. **FIN-2023-04: 2023 Operating Budget**

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the 2023 Net Operating Budget in the amount of $87,884,200 be approved;

2. That the amount of $86,081,800 be set as the General tax levy for 2023.

CARRIED

DRAFT

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Henry, Councillor Tyler Morin, Mayor Collier

Opposed: None

7. Adjournment (5:02 p.m.)

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the February 16, 2023 meeting of the General Government Committee Operating Budget and Capital Budget Meeting be adjourned.

CARRIED

DRAFT

DRAFT MINUTES - Subject to Approval

Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on February 21, 2023

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair – Regional Councillor	S. Lee
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		L. Bower
		N. Henry
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Chair Lee called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 **Regular Meeting**

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on December 12, 2022 be adopted.

CARRIED

With the consent of Members present, item 5.1 was advanced in the order business.

5. Discussion

5.1 **2022 Integrity Commissioner Annual Report**

Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Service/Clerk, introduced Meghan Cowan, Integrity Commissioner, Aird & Berlis LLP.

M. Cowan reviewed the contents of the 2022 Integrity Commissioner Annual Report, key functions of the Integrity Commissioner, and costs incurred.

Committee Members asked questions regarding the amended application to the Human Rights Tribunal of Ontario (HRTO), next steps related to the suspended HRTO application, cumulative costs, status of complaint 2022-01, code of conduct limitation periods, and timelines associated with the next review of the Town's Code of Conduct. M. Cowan and N. Cooper, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the 2022 Annual Report of the Integrity Commissioner be received for information.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2 and 4.3 for discussion.

4.1 LIS-2023-02: 2022 Municipal & School Board Elections: Debrief Assessment

Committee Members asked questions regarding the candidate event program specifically the future management of the program, rationale for the Town's website failing on Election Day, strategies to mitigate future technology issues, and rationale for the selected special voting locations. Jason McWilliam, Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk and Christie McLardie, Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the report '2022 Municipal & School Board Elections: Debrief Assessment' be received for information.

CARRIED

4.2 LIS-2023-04: Electronic Participation Policy

Committee Members asked if the Town procured the same software that is being used by the Region of Durham. N. Cooper responded to the question from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the attached procedures/practices for Electronic Participation (Policy 158) be approved (ATT-1).

CARRIED

4.3 OES-2023-03: Contract Award - Annandale Trail, Design Services

Committee Members sought clarification regarding project scope and inquired about plans for the Dufferin Trail segment. Ranil Fernando, Manager of Infrastructure & Asset Management and Andrew Jackson, Supervisor, Infrastructure Design & Construction,

responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: J. Dies

1. That Council award the contract for the design of the Annandale Trail to The MBTW Group in the amount of $129,334.15 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council approve funding of $91,849.82, to be allocated to Capital Account No. 23004101 from the Capital Contingency Reserve.

CARRIED

6. Presentations

None

Closed Session (1:43 p.m.)

7. Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session

Moved by: L. Bower

That Council convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2) (b), (e) and (f) of the *Municipal Act, 2001,* as amended, to discuss personal matters about an identifiable individual, including municipal or local board employees, litigation or potential litigation, including matters before administrative tribunals, affecting the municipality or local board, and advice that is subject to solicitor-client privilege, including communications necessary for that purpose.

CARRIED

Open Meeting (2:40 p.m.)

7.2 Nominations to Various Region of Durham Committees

Moved by: J. Dies

1. That Ajax Council nominate Lori Roberts for appointment to the Durham Land Division Committee for the 2023-2026 term;

2. That Ajax Council nominate Neil Guthrie for appointment to the Durham Agricultural Advisory Committee (DAAC) for the 2023-2026 term;

3. That Ajax Council nominate Muaz Nasir for appointment to the Durham Environment and Climate Advisory Committee (DECAC) for the 2023-2026 term;

4. That Ajax Council nominate Arshia Ali for appointment to the Durham Transit Advisory Committee (DTAC) for the 2023-2026 term; and

5. That Ajax Council nominate Tanja Van Helsdingen for appointment to the Durham Active Transportation Advisory Committee (DATC) for the 2023-2026 term.

CARRIED

DRAFT

7.3 **Statutory Committees & Boards Membership Appointments**

Moved by: N. Henry

That Council approve the following appointments, to be in effect until February 28, 2027, or until their successors are appointed:

Committee of Adjustment
Wasif Ahmed
Tomas Baca*
Ken Elliott*
Brian Hayes*
Bernadette Santiago*

Property Standards/Animal Services Appeals Committee
Jessica Black
Michelle Kinsella*
Lyndsey McNally
Anderson Mendonca*
Paul Went*

Accessibility Advisory Committee
Tarak Ahmed*
Harneak Burmi*
Kailey Danks
Sepelene Deonarine
Kenneth Kwong*
Adrian Lambert*
Raymond Smith
Kathreen Smith
Heather Steeves

Heritage Advisory Committee
Bruce Balsdon
Hélène Bellerose*
Neil Burnett
Seemil Chaudhry*
Mitchell Daniels*
Paul Hébert
Trish Matthews*
Pam Pryjma
Stephen White
Jeff Wood

* ***denotes new membership***

CARRIED

DRAFT

8. Adjournment (2:41 p.m.)

Moved by: L. Bower

That the February 21, 2023 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED

DRAFT

Town of Ajax Report

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Devon Jarvis, Supervisor of Communications & Engagement
Report #:	CAO-2023-02
Subject:	Council Ward Constituent Newsletter Update
Ward(s):	All
Date of Meeting:	March 20, 2023
Reference:	GGC Report, October 12, 2021 - Council Ward Constituent Newsletter Update - CAO-2021-11 GGC Report, June 14, 2021, - Update to Council Communications Tools & Support Policy - CAO-2021-07 GGC Report, December 20, 2019 - Council Communications Tools & Support Policy

Recommendation:

1. That Council approve Ward Constituent Newsletter A delivery option.

Background:

The Council Communications Tools & Support Policy distinguishes and outlines what support Regional and Local Councillors can expect and request from Corporate Communications in regards to engaging with constituents. As part of the Council Communications Tools & Support Policy, a Ward Constituent Newsletter is to be produced twice annually and distributed to Ajax residents by ward.

The Council Communications Tools & Support Policy, was first presented to Council on November 11, 2019. Council requested one portion of the policy, (the Ward Constituent Newsletter), to be referred back to staff to present additional options for comparison at the December 20, 2019 General Government Committee (GGC) meeting. During the December 20 meeting, staff were asked to conduct a trial to review the effectiveness and delivery method of the Ward Newsletter.

At the December 20, 2019 General Government Committee meeting, Council adopted Ward Newsletter ‘option A’, selecting a 11 x 17 (front and back) printed newsletter including ward and corporate messaging to be delivered via a door to door delivery service – the delivery option, posed a number of challenges. Challenges included: delayed delivery to some areas due to inclement weather and short-staffing from the Covid-19 pandemic, an area receiving the incorrect ward newsletter, and lack of communication and follow up from the delivery service vendor. Concerns were also raised regarding some areas not receiving a newsletter. At the

time, the delivery vendor confirmed that all flyers were delivered. However, there is a margin of error which can be accounted for about 10% of the overall delivery. This is an industry standard for all delivery services. As part of the delivery process, streets were randomly audited throughout Ajax to ensure the deliveries were made. According to their audit report and when compared to our internal GIS database, 339 of 816 residential streets (42%) were audited to confirm delivery.

Due to the above staff were requested to report back again and provide additional delivery options for the remaining Ward Constituent Newsletters for the 2018-2022 term, which included a 2021 fall edition and January 2022 edition to be produced and delivered.

At the June 14, 2021 GGC meeting, staff recommended Ward Constituent Newsletter "A" delivery option of delivery through Metroland (Ajax News Advertiser) for the remaining two newsletter deliveries (September 2021 and January 2022). However, Council opted for the Ward Constituent Newsletter "B" option of delivery through GTA Flyer Delivery, distributed by Canada Post and directed staff to report back on the delivery of the September edition.

The September 2021 edition of the Ward Constituent Newsletters were delivered on time to Ajax households during the week of September 20, 2021. At the time of delivery completion, the delivery company provided a stamped Canada Post receipt confirming the delivery of the 34,657 newsletters. There was an error of Ward 1 newsletters mistakenly delivered to a small area of Ward 2. The delivery company was responsive and rectified the delivery once made aware. As previously noted, there is a margin of error which can be accounted for about 10% of the overall delivery.

The January 2022 edition of the Ward Constituent Newsletters were delivered on time to Ajax houses during the week of January 24, 2022. At the time of delivery completion, the delivery company provided a stamped Canada Post receipt confirming the delivery of the 34,738 newsletters. There were concerns raised by Ward 1 and Ward 2 Council members of some streets not receiving the newsletter.

Discussion:

The following tables are provided for review for the Ward Constituent Newsletter delivery options for the 2022 – 2026 Council Term:

Ward E-Newsletter – Option A Electronic:

- Would be designed in-house, produced per ward twice annually and would be electronic only.
- Most economical option (limited staff resources and lowest cost)
- "Greenest" option, follows our commitment to the environment and reducing paper consumption.
- Option to print select amount for our community centres or for Coucillors to provide to residents who request a hard copy.
- Allows timely, direct and consistent communication with constituents.
- Would leverage Corporate Communications channels, networks and communities to increase reach and visibility. In addition, electronic ward newsletter data bases would also be utilized.
- Removes requirement of a work back schedule for councillor content as external printing and delivery deadlines would not have to be met and ultimately provides the most current content for residents.

- Most reliable delivery option

Ward Newsletter Delivery – Option B Metroland (Ajax News Advertiser):

- Would be designed in-house to be 11 x 17 (front & back) for print and online, produced per ward twice annually and would include ward and corporate messaging.
- Total print cost would be approximately $3,887.15
    - Ward 1 cost: $1,183.92
    - Ward 2 cost: $1,336.03
    - Ward 3 cost: 1,367.20
- Total delivery cost would be approximately $1,474.43
    - Ward 1 cost: $449.07
    - Ward 2 cost: $506.77
    - Ward 3 cost: $518.59
- Town of Ajax has worked and partnered with Metroland for over 15 years on the delivery of Ajax Today (homeowner newsletter) and numerous specialty campaigns without issue.
- Consistently provides the same level of service and reliability.
- Would be delivered within the weekly edition of the Ajax News Advertiser
- Some households have opted to request to not receive the Ajax News Advertiser
    - To consider: a household who has opted to not receive the News Advertiser may not want other types of newsletters being delivered.
    - Metroland is able to accommodate delivery to the houses who have opted to not receive the News Advertiser via Canada post for an additional $1,756
- Printing may be subject to increases.

Ward Newsletter Delivery – Option C CF&R Delivery:

- Would be designed in-house to be 11 x 17 (front & back) for print and online, produced per ward twice annually and would include ward and corporate messaging.
- Total print cost would be approximately $3,887.15
    - Ward 1 cost: $1,183.92
    - Ward 2 cost: $1,336.03
    - Ward 3 cost: 1,367.20
- Total delivery cost would be approximately $6,365.74
    - Ward 1 cost: $2,031.22
    - Ward 2 cost: $2,099.50
    - Ward 3 cost: $2,235.02
- Highest cost option
- New vendor that has not been used previously for this type of work for the Town.
- Printing may be subject to increases.
- Uses Canada Post for delivery, requires newsletter to be folded to 5.5 x 8.5
- Heavy work back schedule and firm deadline for Councillor content to meet printing and delivery deadlines.
- Cannot guarantee reliability of delivery through third party flyer delivery services; Council has previously expressed concerns with Canada Post delivery.
- Previous delivery through third-party organizations have posed challenges such as: subject to staffing and inclement weather delays, unreliability, communication issues, and significant Town staff time and resources used.

Ajax Today – Option D:

- Corporate newsletter, produced once annually.
- Low cost option.
- Consistent messaging.

Financial Implications:

To be determined based on Council option decision.

Communication Issues:

N/A

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

N/A

Conclusion:

The *Council Communications Tools & Support* Policy provides important updates and clarifications and outline processes and expectations for both Council Members and staff. The Ward Constituent Newsletter will allow timely information to residents specific to their local neighbourhoods.

Attachments:

ATT-1: Council Communication Tools & Support Policy #143

Prepared by:

Devon Jarvis – Supervisor of Communications & Engagement

Submitted by:

Christie McLardie – Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

CORPORATION OF THE TOWN OF AJAX
CORPORATE POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

SUBJECT:

COUNCIL COMMUNICATIONS TOOLS & SUPPORT

COUNCIL ISSUED:	COUNCIL REVISED:	AUTHORED BY:	REVISION #:	Page 1 of 3	POLICY #:
19/12/20	21 / 06 / 21	Rachael Wraith	2		145

1. POLICY OBJECTIVE

1.1. Outline the corporate communications tools available to councillors to inform and engage with constituents.

1.2. Overview of the communications support offered to councillors by Corporate Communications.

1.3. This policy continues to apply in an election year, subject to the *Use of Corporate Resources for Elections Purposes Policy*. In any case where these two policies conflict, the Use of *Corporate Resources for Elections Purposes Policy* shall prevail.

2. SCOPE

2.1. Regional and local councillors

2.2. Corporate Communications

2.3. Excludes support provided by the Manager of Strategic and Public Affairs, Senior Advisor, Government and Stakeholder Relations and Administrative Assistant – Council.

2.4. Excludes support provided to the Mayor.

3. Ward Constituent Newsletter

3.1. Produced by Corporate Communications twice annually, the four-page 11” x 17” (front and back, soft folded) newsletter is distributed to homeowners (by ward) and electronically via ward email contact list. In Year 4, only one edition (January 2022) will be produced to account for the next municipal election.

3.2. The newsletter is a joint communications piece between regional and local ward councillors. Individual councillor ward newsletters are not permitted.

3.3. Councillors are responsible for the ward specific content (pages 1-3) of each edition which must be provided to the Manager of Corporate Communications by the

established deadline. A work-back schedule will be provided to Council at the start of each calendar year in order to prepare.

3.4. Content provided by councillors must be timely, consistent with Town messaging and positions, and include no confidential information. Corporate Communications will review final content to ensure information is consistent and without error. All changes will be shared with councillors.

3.5. Corporate Communications is responsible for page 4 of each newsletter, which will include timely corporate information and news.

3.6. A newsletter template is used to ensure graphic consistency with our corporate brand standards, link the ward newsletters as a corporate initiative, and manage staff capacity.

3.7. The delivery of the ward newsletters will occur approximately the last week of January and September each year.

3.8. An electronic version of the ward newsletters will be provided to councillors for distribution through external social media channels. The newsletters will also be shared through the Town's corporate communications channels.

4. Website

4.1. Each councillor is profiled on the Town's corporate website (ajax.ca) on a dedicated page called Councillor Members (ajax.ca/councilmembers).

4.2. The standard councillor web profile includes a photo, contact information and biography.

4.3. The following enhancements may be requested:

4.3.1. Welcome video (only two updates permitted per term).
4.3.2. External links to constituent websites and social media accounts (excludes personal and election campaign sites).
4.3.3. Listing of Ward Constituent Newsletters.
4.3.4. Listing of Regional Council Reports.
4.3.5. Listing of approved Regional and Council Resolutions (must have been moved by or seconded by councillor).

4.4. Council Members are responsible for the setup and management of external constituent websites. Upon request, staff may provide content management, design support and functionality assistance. New constituent websites whose design, set-up, domain registration, and/or hosting are paid for by the Town are not permitted to be converted to an election website by a Member seeking re-election as they are the property of the Town.

5. Social Media

5.1. Each councillor is responsible for the setup and day-to-day management and monitoring of constituent social media accounts (Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, etc.). Upon request, the Social Media Communications Coordinator may provide guidance and assistance on functionality, content management, strategy, tutorials and opportunities. Excludes personal and election campaign accounts.

5.2. Corporate Communications, where appropriate, will tag councillor accounts in Town posts (content or images) for increased sharing of corporate messaging. Similarly, councillors are encouraged to tag Town accounts for increased sharing and profile.

5.3. Councillors have the **option** to provide constituent social media account information (admin support or full access) to the Social Media Communications Coordinator for enhanced support. Enhanced support includes:

5.3.1. Timely sharing of corporate messaging, including announcements, initiatives, projects etc., and Council pieces such as the Ward Constituent Newsletter.
5.3.2. Building online profile and presence.
5.3.3. Assisting with constituent requests/inquiries, when required.
5.3.4. Posting of councillor community and event photos/videos.
5.3.5. Posting of councillor-initiated graphics and videos.
5.3.6. Implement councillor-initiated social media campaigns.

6. Branding, Marketing & Public Relations

6.1. Upon request, Corporate Communications is available to provide the following branding, marketing and public relations services and expertise. Council members are encouraged to access and utilize available corporate communications supports before seeking the services of a third party provider.

6.1.1. Creative Services

Digital and creative support including branding, graphic, videography and photography support to promote and market initiatives councillors are championing. This could be at the local or regional level via committees, ward projects, and/or specific priorities that align with Council positions. Support includes strategy, messaging, digital production and distribution. Printing is charged to the Councillor(s) budget(s).

6.1.2. Online Communications

Content management, design support and functionality assistance for constituent social media accounts - Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, YouTube – (see section 5.1) and constituent websites (see section 4.4).

6.2. Any branding, marketing and public relations services provided by Corporate Communications cannot be used by a Member seeking re-election as they are property of the Town.

7. Advertising

7.1. Corporate Communications coordinates Council advertisements as required. These may include ads within the Town's weekly Community Page or specialilty greetings on behalf of all of Council. Upon request, Corporate Communications will assist with individual ad prep and placement subject to the *Council Expense Policy*. Council members are encouraged to notify Corporate Communications of ad placement to ensure alignment and consistency with corporate advertising, positions and messaging.

8. Media Relations

8.1. Corporate Communications may provide strategic media relations support to councillors wishing to seek publicity for priorities that align with Council positions. This includes coordinating media and photo opportunities and assisting with interview preparation. Refer to the Town's *Media Relations Policy* for media request procedures.

9. Ward Meetings

9.1. Refer to *Ward Meeting Policy.*

Town of Ajax Report

Report To:	General Governance Committee
Prepared By:	Mary Lou Cosentino, Manager HR Services
Report #:	CAO 2023-03
Subject:	**Vaccination Policy**
Ward(s):	n/a
Date of Meeting:	March 20, 2023
Reference:	Vaccination Policy

Recommendation:

That Council approves the suspension of the Town's Vaccination Policy.

Background:

At a special meeting on August 31, 2021 Council adopted the following resolution:

THAT the Town's Municipal Emergency Control Group develop and implement a mandatory Covid-19 vaccination policy requiring all Town employees to disclose and provide proof of vaccination status based on advice from legal counsel. The policy should consider valid/reasonable human rights and medical exemptions.

The Town's Municipal Emergency Control Group developed a mandatory vaccination policy which required all Town staff (full time and part time staff) to provide proof of vaccination. Staff were also provided with the opportunity to submit medical or religious exemptions. In addition, all new employees were also required to provide proof of vaccination in order to secure employment with the Town.

The City of Toronto and most of the GTA municipalities developed similar vaccination policies. Many municipalities have been challenged by the unions who were opposed to the mandatory vaccination policies and filed grievances which went forward to arbitration for resolution. Arbitrators in Ontario have consistently upheld the reasonableness of implementing a mandatory vaccination policy in the face of unprecedented public health crisis. Understandably employers had to act in order to minimize the risk of the spread of the COVID-19 crisis. However, the reasonableness for having a "mandatory" policy in place today needs to be re-considered. Over the last several months, there have been a number of developments as a result of various arbitration awards and subsequently many municipalities have changed the status of their vaccination policies. Toronto has revised their policy from a "mandatory" policy to a policy that "strongly encourages" vaccination and has reinstated all of the unionized employees that were terminated. Other GTA municipalities have followed suit in either

suspending, revoking or revising their policies and reinstating their unionized staff to avoid arbitration costs. Generally speaking, municipalities who are upholding their mandatory vaccination policies are in long term care settings.

Discussion:

It is recommended that the Town suspends its Vaccination Policy effective immediately based on the discontinuation of COVID-19 restrictions, recent arbitration awards, decisions of other municipalities and input from senior management. The decision to suspend rather than terminate it is due to the possibility of a resurgence of the COVID-19 virus and need to reinstate the policy for stronger measures quickly.

Financial Implications:

There are no financial implications.

Communication Issues:

The Town will communicate the suspension of the Vaccination Policy to all staff.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

N/A

Conclusion:

The Town will continue to closely monitor its COVID-19 risk mitigation strategies to ensure that the Town continues to optimally protect the health and safety of employees in the workplace and the public.

Attachment: Vaccination Policy

Prepared by:

Mary Lou Cosentino – Manager, HR Services

Submitted by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

CORPORATION OF THE TOWN OF AJAX

CORPORATE POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

SUBJECT: Workplace COVID-19 Vaccination Policy

COUNCIL ISSUED: 21 / 10 / 12	REVISED: 21 / 12 / 06	AUTHORED BY: Mary Lou Cosentino on behalf of MECG	REVISION #: 3	Page 1 of 10	POLICY #: 115

1. POLICY STATEMENTS:

1.1 The Health and Safety of Town of Ajax (Town) employees is a top priority. As prescribed under the Occupational Health and Safety Act (Ontario), 1990 the Town is obligated as well as committed to taking every precaution reasonable in the circumstances for the protection of the health and safety of workers from the hazard of COVID-19.

1.2 COVID-19 vaccines provide a high level of protection against COVID-19 and related variants. In addition, it lowers the risk of serious illness and hospitalization.

1.3 This policy recognizes that those who are unvaccinated or not fully vaccinated pose a significantly increased risk of becoming seriously ill from COVID-19 and also of spreading the virus to others, which has a significant impact on an individuals' health and well-being and access to a safe workplace.

1.4 With the continuing spread of COVID-19, within Ontario, the compelling data demonstrating a higher incidence of COVID-19 among the unvaccinated population and the increasing levels of contact between individuals as businesses, services and activities have reopened, it is important for Town employees to be fully vaccinated in order to protect themselves against serious illness as well as to provide indirect protection to others, including colleagues.

1.5 As such, this policy requires employees to be fully vaccinated from COVID-19 and provide Proof of Vaccination, unless otherwise provided for in this policy, and complete any subsequent doses as recommended by the Ministry of Health, Ontario Public Health or the Region of Durham Health Department (i.e. booster doses).

1.6 Employees who are not able to obtain a COVID-19 vaccine for reasons related to a protected ground under the Ontario Human Rights Code may request accommodation.

1.7 To support the elimination and reduction of risk of COVID-19 transmission, this Workplace COVID-19 Vaccination Policy is an important measure that complements other workplace health and safety measures and protocols in place, including and not limited to daily health screening, self- monitoring of potential Covid-19 symptoms, mandatory masking, using provided PPE, physical distancing, proper hand hygiene, and enhanced cleaning protocols, etc. when at work or otherwise engaged in Town business.

1.8 It is understood that the provincial and regional approach to reducing the spread of COVID-19 continues to remain fluid and evolving. As such, this policy may be subject to amendment from time to time as required.

2. OBJECTIVE

2.1 To take steps to eliminate or minimize the risk of COVID-19 in the workplace and to provide a safe environment for staff and patrons.

2.2 To provide guidelines and education pertaining to the expectations and requirements of employees with regard to COVID-19 vaccination.

2.3 To provide direction to employees on the requirement to receive the COVID-19 vaccination, provide proof of vaccination or a bona fide exemption, and conditions for attending work without vaccination, if applicable.

2.4 To maximize COVID-19 vaccination rates among Town employees as one of the critical control measures for the hazard of COVID-19.

3. SCOPE

3.1 This policy applies to all employees of the Town of Ajax, including full-time, part-time, permanent, temporary, casual, and paid and unpaid (co-op) students.

3.2 New employees will be subject to this policy as a condition of their employment.

3.3 Contractors will be required to have a vaccination policy, the Town will review requirements for others including and not limited to patrons, volunteers and visitors separately.

3.4 All employees to whom this policy applies will have this policy shared with them on, or as close to, the date of the policy coming into force. Workers will be required to acknowledge that they have read and understood the policy.

3.5 This policy does not govern Ajax Council Members.

4. DEFINITIONS

4.1 **Town or Employer:** Refers to the Corporation of the Town of Ajax

4.2 **Employees** shall mean all employees of the Town of Ajax, including full-time, part-time, permanent, temporary, casual, and paid and unpaid (co-op) students

4.3 **COVID-19** is a virus belonging to a large family called coronavirus which includes the virus that causes the common cold and more severe disease such as Severe Acute

Respiratory Syndrome (SARs) and Middle East Respiratory Syndrome (MERS-COV). The virus that causes COVID-19 is a novel coronavirus, named SARS-CoV-2**.**

4.4 **Fully Vaccinated** is an individual who has received a full COVID-19 vaccine series approved by Health Canada (e.g., two doses of a two-dose vaccine series + 14 days, or one dose of a single-dose vaccine series + 14 days). A list of vaccines approved by Health Canada can be found at https://www.canada.ca/en/health-canada/services/drugs-health-products/covid19-industry/drugs-vaccines-treatments/vaccines.html

4.5 **Partially Vaccinated** is an individual who has received one dose of a two-dose vaccine series or received the 2nd dose but the requisite 14 days has not passed.

4.6 **Unvaccinated** is an individual who has not received any doses of a COVID-19 vaccine; includes employees who have not disclosed their vaccination status.

4.7 **Vaccine** is defined as a substance used to stimulate the production of antibodies and provide immunity against SARS-CoV-2

4.8 **Proof of Vaccination:** Refers to documentation issued by the Ontario Ministry of Health, other province or territory or international equivalent indicating individual immunization status against the COVID-19 virus. Copies can be obtained by logging in to the provincial vaccine portal at https://covid19.ontariohealth.ca

4.9 **Exemptions** refers to an employee who is exempted from proof of vaccination or from being fully vaccinated based on a Human Rights ground or medical condition that requires accommodation.

4.10 **Contraindication** is a condition or circumstance that suggests or indicates that a particular technique or drug should not be used in the case in question.

5. RESPONSIBILITIES

5.1 Department Heads/Managers and Supervisors are expected to:

a) Follow and comply with any federal and provincial mandates or directives regarding the vaccination of staff.
b) Communicate, support and/or follow-up with employees as requested by Human Resource Services.
c) Actively participate in any workplace accommodation discussions that may arise through Policy implementation and provide reasonable accommodation to employees as obligated under the Ontario Human Rights Code.
d) Support any required accommodation plans pertaining to an exemption pursuant to the OHRC, as established with Human Resources.
e) Continue to enforce workplace precautions that limit the spread of COVID-19 and ensure all employees adhere to COVID-19 policies and protocols.

f) Make all efforts to allow an employee to use time at the beginning or end of their shift day or to extend lunch and break times as operationally feasible with work schedules to attend vaccination clinics.

5.2 Employees are expected to:

a) Comply and adhere to the timelines in the COVID-19 Vaccination Policy.
b) Submit the required Proof of Vaccination and supporting documentation in accordance with this Policy.
c) Ensure that the required educational session regarding the benefits of vaccinations is completed where indicated.
d) Ensure subsequent booster doses are received if recommended by Public Health.
e) Submit valid documentation to support a request for accommodation pursuant to the OHRC, if applicable, and follow established accommodation plans.
f) Submit to ongoing COVID-19 testing where such testing requirements are in place.
g) Follow additional infection and prevention control measures if deemed necessary.
h) Ensure that COVID-19 health and safety policies and protocols continue to be followed.
i) Endeavour to remain informed about the importance of being vaccinated and any changes in vaccination requirements issued by the Federal or Provincial government or Public Health.

5.3 Human Resource Services are expected to:

a) Collect and safeguard Proof of Vaccination in accordance with the Mandatory COVID-19 Vaccination Policy and ensure records are collected and used in compliance with applicable privacy legislation.
b) Provide an educational program and other information as required to employees about the importance of being vaccinated.
c) Review documentation submitted by employees requesting exemptions and when required, work with employees and supervisors/managers where a human rights exemption is substantiated to develop a reasonable and appropriate accommodation plan ensuring that adequate health and safety measures are in place.
d) Ensure all future hires, students and volunteers are aware of and meet the requirements of this policy.
e) Provide advice and guidance to staff and management as required.

6. COMPLIANCE

6.1 The following chart outlines the compliance dates:

October 29, 2021	All Town of Ajax employees are required to disclose their COVID-19 vaccination status by completing the Town's COVID-19 Vaccination Declaration Form
October 29, 2021	Employees who are requesting exemptions based on a protected ground of the Ontario Human Rights Code, must submit the required documentation to Human Resource Services
November 12, 2021	With the exception of employees who have an approved exemption, all employees who have not been vaccinated or did not disclose their vaccination status are to complete a mandatory COVID-19 vaccination education course
November 19, 2021	Employees who have not been vaccinated or did not disclose their vaccination status, must provide proof of first dose to Human Resource Services
January 21, 2022	All staff who are not fully vaccinated (i.e. have only received first dose), must provide proof of second dose to Human Resource Services
February 4, 2022	All employees are required to be fully vaccinated (i.e. two doses of a two-dose vaccine series + 14 days, or one dose of a single-dose vaccine series + 14 days)

6.2 It should be noted that the above dates may be adjusted at the discretion of HR Services on a case by case basis. Any adjustments to the compliance dates will be confirmed in writing from HR Services to the employee.

6.3 The Employer will assess any breach of this policy, including the submission of fraudulent documentation relating to this policy, on a case-by-case basis and will determine the appropriate recourse based on what is reasonable in the circumstances. It is understood that one such recourse may include discipline up to and including termination of employment.

6.4 Employees who are on a leave of absence (i.e. maternity/parental leave, LTD, etc.) will have 45 days upon return to work to provide their proof of full vaccination, as required.

7. CONSULTATION WITH HR SERVICES

7.1 Staff wishing to discuss their individual circumstances with Human Resource Services prior to completing the Town's Vaccination Declaration Form, the medical exemption form or the statement of Creed/Religious Belief forms may do so by requesting an appointment by email at hrservices@ajax.ca

8. ACCOMMODATIONS UNDER THE ONTARIO HUMAN RIGHTS CODE

8.1 All requests for accommodation under the Human Rights Code will be reviewed by HR Services. All requests shall require written proof of the need for accommodation to be submitted.

8.2 Human Resource Services reserves the right to request supporting documentation to support exemption/accommodation requests. Incomplete forms will be returned to the employee to provide the missing information.

8.3 Declared exemptions will be reviewed on a case-by-case basis and, if validated and determined bona fide, would be subject to the Town's accommodation process.

8.4 The Town will work with employees with exemptions to develop a safe, reasonable and appropriate accommodation plan. In exceptional cases, where such an accommodation is not possible, the employee may utilize their allotted vacation time/lieu time or will be placed on an unpaid leave to be reviewed at a time interval established by Human Resource Services.

8.5 Currently it is understood that there are very few medical reasons for not receiving the COVID-19 vaccine. Recognized medical reasons for not being able to receive the COVID-19 vaccination include:

a) A severe allergy to a component of the vaccine as confirmed by an Allergist or Immunologist, registered in good standing with the College of Physicians and Surgeons of Ontario.

b) Confirmation by the employee's medical doctor who is in good standing with the College of Physicians and Surgeons of Ontario that the employee was diagnosed with developing myocarditis or pericarditis after a dose of an mRNA vaccine.

8.6 Employees seeking a medical exemption must complete and email or mail the Medical Request for COVID-19 Accommodation form to Nancy Marchese, Sr. Advisor, Health, Wellness and Learning by October 29, 2021.

8.7 Written proof of a medical reason, provided by a physician or nurse practitioner must set out:

a) That the COVID-19 vaccination is contraindicated for a medical reason and the person cannot be vaccinated against COVID-19 and;
b) The effective time period for the medical reason (i.e., permanent or time-limited).

8.8 Employees seeking a non-medical exemption are required to complete and email or mail the Statement of Creed/Religious Belief form to Fay Calliste, Sr. Advisor, Labour and Employee Relations and have it sworn or affirmed before a Commissioner of Oaths by October 29, 2021.

8.9 Philosophical objections are not considered a protected ground under the Human Rights Code

9. DISCLOSURE OF COVID-19 VACCINATION STATUS

9.1 Employees must complete the Town's online COVID-19 Vaccination Declaration Form available on OLA no later than October 29, 2021.

9.2 Employees fully or partially vaccinated are required to upload proof of vaccination documents issued by the Ontario Ministry of Health, other province or territory or international equivalent indicating individual immunization status against the COVID-19 virus by October 29, 2021. Copies can be obtained by logging in to the provincial vaccine portal at https://covid19.ontariohealth.ca

9.3 Employees seeking a medical exemption are required to complete and upload the Medical Request for COVID-19 Accommodation Form by October 29, 2021.

9.4 Employees seeking a non-medical exemption are required to complete and upload the Statement of Creed/Religious Belief form and have it sworn or affirmed before a Commissioner of Oaths by October 29, 2021.

9.5 All employees must be fully vaccinated by February 4, 2022, unless otherwise approved by HR Services.

9.6 Employees shall obtain any future required COVID-19 Vaccine booster(s) and provide updated Proof of Vaccination upon request from Human Resource Services.

9.7 Employees who do not have access to a computer, may submit a hard copy of the declaration form and their proof of vaccination, directly to Human Resource Services in an envelope marked "confidential" no later than October 29, 2021.

10. MANDATORY COVID-19 VACCINATION EDUCATION

10.1 Employees who have not been vaccinated or who do not disclose their vaccination status are to complete a mandatory COVID-19 vaccination education course that has been approved by the Town of Ajax that covers the risks of being unvaccinated in the workplace by November 12, 2021.

10.2 Employees required to take this mandatory education course will be notified by Human Resource Services and provided instructions on how to complete the course.

10.3 It is the responsibility of the employee to complete and provide proof of completion within the time prescribed.

10.4 Employees who are identified to attend a mandatory COVID-19 vaccination education course but chose not to attend may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

10.5 Employees who do not disclose their COVID-19 vaccination status or do not complete the mandatory education session, may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

11. TESTING REQUIREMENTS

11.1 Effective October 30, 2021 the following Town staff must undertake Covid-19 testing:

- staff who have not submitted a declaration form
- staff who are unvaccinated
- staff who are not fully vaccinated (i.e. have only received 1st dose or completing 14 day waiting period)
- staff who have are awaiting approval of, or have been approved for, a medical or religious exemption

11.2 Affected staff are required to get tested for Covid-19 two times per week, or pending work schedule, within 72 hours of their shift, and provide proof of testing (receipts) to Human Resource Services.

11.3 PCR or rapid antigen tests are acceptable. Receipts can be emailed electronically to hrservices@ajax.ca and/or dropped off in-person to Human Resource Services at Town Hall.

11.4 Rapid-antigen home tests are acceptable however, you must email the receipt of purchase to hrservices@ajax.ca, and email to confirm that you have taken a test, prior to attending work (see 11.2).

11.5 The cost of tests will not be covered by the Town with the following exceptions:

1. In situations where and employee has:
   a) an approved exemption
   b) been partially vaccinated
   c) made the effort to comply with the policy by getting vaccinated

2. In order to be reimbursed for the cost of the tests the employee must provide proof of payment to their supervisor for reimbursement.

12. VACCINE APPOINTMENTS

12.1 Every effort should be made to secure vaccine appointments before or after working hours however, reasonable arrangements will be made to allow for staff to attend COVID-19 vaccination clinics during work time. Employees may be provided up to two hours of regular pay time, without reducing any other paid leave banks when they are unable to secure an appointment outside work hours. Employees must have approval from their supervisor in advance before attending a clinic during work time.

13. NON-COMPLIANCE

13.1 Employees who do not comply with the timelines as set out in the policy, will be placed on an unpaid leave of absence.

13.2 If an employee wishes to return to the workplace, they must provide proof of full vaccination (i.e. 2 doses of a 2 dose series +14 days or 1 dose of a 1 dose series + 14 days).

13.3 Failure to provide proof and/or comply with the provisions of this policy, will be dealt with on a case by case basis and may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

14. CONFIDENTIALITY

14.1 The Town will verify vaccination disclosure information, including documentation verifying receipt of a vaccination series, in accordance with privacy legislation. This information will only be used to the extent necessary for implementation of this policy, for administering health and safety protocols, and infection and prevention control measures in the workplace.

14.2 This information and documentation will be retained in Human Resource Services, until such time that the information is no longer required, and then will be subsequently discarded.

15. CONTINUED ADHERENCE TO PUBLIC HEALTH MEASURES

15.1 All employees are required to practice Public Health measures to control the spread of COVID-19 regardless of their vaccination status.

15.2 Employees must adhere to the Town's health and safety policies and protocols at all times while in the workplace, including handwashing, physical distancing where possible, and the use of Personal Protective Equipment as required by their position.

15.3 Employees who develop symptoms of suspected COVID-19 must follow the guidance as outlined in the town's COVID-19 screening and COVID-19 protocols.

15.4 Employees who test positive for COVID-19 must follow the guidance outlined in the Town's Safety Plan.

16 REFERENCES

a) Ontario Proof of Vaccination Policy

b) Directive #6 for Public Hospitals

c) Human Rights Code (Ontario)

d) Occupational Health and Safety Act (Ontario)

e) Ministry of Health website, where individuals may review vaccine information, testing sites etc.

f) http://www.ohrc.on.ca/en/news_centre/ohrc-policy-statement-covid-19-vaccine-mandates-and-proof-vaccine-certificates

Town of Ajax Report

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Mary Lou Cosentino, Manager HR Services
Report #:	CAO – 2023-04
Subject:	**OMERS By-law**
Ward:	n/a
Date of Meeting:	March 20, 2023
Reference:	OMERS By Law No.

Recommendation:

That the proposed OMERS By-law (ATT-1) which provides the Town of Ajax authorization to participate in the OMERS plan effective January 1, 2023, be brought forward to the March 27th, 2023 Council meeting for approval.

Background:

On January 1, 1974 the Town of Ajax passed by-law 63-74 which authorized participation in OMERS for all full time staff and by-law 64-74 was also passed which authorized participation of Councillors in the OMERS plan.

On January 1, 1975 by-law 6-75 repealed by-law 64-74 and removed Council's participation in the OMERS plan.

In lieu of participating in the OMERS plan, the Town of Ajax has been providing RRSP contributions on behalf of Members of Council.

On December 12, 2022, Council passed a motion that "The Manager of HR Services be directed to contact OMERS indicating Council's intent to participate in the OMERS Plan and obtain the necessary information and documentation to commence the process".

Discussion:

OMERS By-law (ATT-1) has now been revised to include the participation of Council in the OMERS plan. All current members of Council shall have the option to join the OMERS plan. Should they choose not to join the OMERS plan, the Town will continue to provide RRSP contributions on their behalf. Once a decision has been made to join the plan, the Member of Council will continue to participate in the plan for as long as they continue to be employed as a Member of Council. It should be noted that any new members of Council in the future will not have an option to join the plan and their participation in the plan shall be mandatory.

Financial Implications:

The Town of Ajax shall match the contribution that the Member of Council makes into the OMERS plan.

OMERS contribution rates for 2023 include 9% of salary up to the YMPE (66,600 for 2023) and 14.6% of salary over YMPE. The salary for Ajax Council fall under the YMPE value, however, if the Town and Region harmonize Council salaries, then the combined Regional salary would trigger an amount subject to the 14.6% contribution rate. The OMERS contribution would be shared proportionately with the Region. The table below provides an estimate of the impact to Council's salary for OMERS.

	Town RRSP – 10%	OMERS	Change
Local*	$4,447	$4,002	($465)
Regional*	$4,447	$4,894	$447
Mayor*	$11,853	$14,819	$2,966

*2022 salaries were used in the calculation

Communication Issues:

Changes outlined in this report will be communicated through an email to all affected Members of Council.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

Not applicable

Conclusion:

OMERS By-law (ATT-1) provides the authorization for the participation in the OMERS plan for full time staff and Members of Council.

Attachments:

ATT-1: Proposed OMERS By-law - OMERS Participation

ATT-2: By-law 63-74

ATT-3: By-law 64-74

Prepared by:

Mary Lou Cosentino – Manager, HR Services

Submitted by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

THE CORPORATION OF THE TOWN OF AJAX

BY-LAW NUMBER XX-2023

A **By-Law** to confirm and authorize participation in the OMERS Primary Pension Plan ("Primary Plan") and the Retirement Compensation Arrangement for the OMERS Primary Pension Plan ("RCA"), each as amended from time to time, of the employees and councillors of the **Corporation of the Town of Ajax** ("Employer") identified herein.

WHEREAS the Employer is eligible to participate in the Primary Plan and the RCA in accordance with subsection 5(1) of the *Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement System Act, 2006*, as amended from time to time ("OMERS Act, 2006"), in respect of its eligible employees and does so in accordance with the applicable Primary Plan and RCA documents and applicable legislation;

AND WHEREAS pursuant to subsection 6(1) of the Primary Plan, the Employer may, by by-law or resolution, participate in the Primary Plan and the RCA and pay to the funds for the Primary Plan and the RCA the total of the employer and member contributions required by the Primary Plan, and has all of the powers necessary and incidental thereto;

AND WHEREAS the Employer previously enacted **By-Law Number 63-74** and elected to participate in the Primary Plan and the RCA in respect of its eligible employees and confirmed that eligible firefighter employees, participate in the Plan and the RCA with a normal retirement age of 60;

AND WHEREAS the Employer is a municipality and, pursuant to subsection 5(2) of the OMERS Act, 2006, a municipality may participate in the Primary Plan and the RCA in respect of its councillors;

AND WHEREAS the Employer previously enacted **By-Law Number 64-74** and elected to participate in the Primary Plan and the RCA in respect of its councillors effective January 1, 1974

AND WHEREAS the Employer subsequently enacted **By-Law Number 6-75** and elected to withdraw participation in the Primary Plan and the RCA in respect of its councillors effective January 1, 1975;

AND WHEREAS the Employer wishes to enact a **By-Law** to: (i) reconfirm the Employer's election to participate in the Primary Plan and the RCA in respect of its eligible employees in an updated format; and (ii) effective January 1, 2023 make an election to participate in the Primary Plan and the RCA in respect of its councillors, inclusive of its head of council;

THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED THAT, effective **March 20, 2023** ("Effective Date"), or as otherwise indicated, the **Council** enacts as follows:

(Continuation of Participation)	1.	The Employer shall continue to participate in the Primary Plan and the RCA in accordance with the terms of the Primary Plan, RCA, and applicable legislation, each as amended from time to time.
(Existing Members)	2.	For greater certainty, the Employer continues to participate in the Primary Plan and the RCA in respect of all of its employees and councillors (defined below) who were members of the Primary Plan and the RCA on the day immediately preceding the Effective Date.
(Election re: Employees)	3.	The Employer shall participate in the Primary Plan and the RCA in respect of each person who is employed by the Employer and who is eligible to be a member of the Primary Plan and the RCA under subsection 5(3) of the OMERS Act, 2006 ("Employee") as of the Effective Date in accordance with the terms of the Primary Plan, RCA, and applicable legislation, each as amended from time to time.

(Future CFT Employees)

4. An Employee who becomes an Employee employed on a continuous full-time basis, as defined in subsection 9(1) of the Primary Plan, as amended from time to time ("CFT Employee"), on or after the Effective Date shall, as a condition of employment, become a member of the Primary Plan and the RCA, or if such person is already a member, resume contributions to the Primary Plan and the RCA on the date so employed.

(Membership for OTCFT Employees)

5. An Employee who is employed on other than a continuous full-time basis ("OTCFT Employee") and meets the eligibility criteria in subsection 9(6) of the Primary Plan, as amended from time to time, is entitled to become a member of the Primary Plan and the RCA in accordance with the terms of the Primary Plan, as amended from time to time.

(NRA 60 Option for Fire)

6. Employees who are employed by the Employer and, in respect of that employment, meet the definition of "firefighter" in subsection 1(1) of the *Fire Protection and Prevention Act, 1997*, as amended from time to time, shall continue to have a normal retirement age of 60 years under the Primary Plan and the RCA, as applicable, in accordance with the terms of the Primary Plan, RCA, and applicable legislation, each as amended from time to time.

(Election re: All Councillors)

7. The Employer shall participate in the Primary Plan and the RCA in respect of each of its councillors (inclusive of its head of council) who meet the definition of "councillor" in subsection 1(1) of the Primary Plan, as amended from time to time ("Councillor"), as of the first day of January 2023 ("Councillor Effective Date") in accordance with the terms of the Primary Plan, RCA, and applicable legislation, each as amended from time to time.

(Current Councillors)

8. A Councillor in office on the Councillor Effective Date is entitled to become a member of the Primary Plan and the RCA on the first day of the month following the month in which the Councillor's application is received by the OMERS Administration Corporation ("AC"), provided that the AC may, at the request of the Employer, fix an earlier date on which the Councillor becomes a member but not before the date on which the Councillor became entitled to be a member or the first day of January in the year in which the application is received by the AC, whichever is the later date.

(Future Councillors)

9. Every person who becomes a Councillor after the Councillor Effective Date shall become a member of the Primary Plan and RCA on the date the person becomes a Councillor.

(Senior Management Official)

10. Any person who holds a senior management position with the Employer ("Senior Management Official"), as the Employer may designate from time to time, is hereby authorized on behalf of the Employer to take all such action and execute all such documents, certificates and agreements, as they may consider necessary to give effect to the provisions of this By-Law and to fulfill the Employer's duties and obligations with respect to the Primary Plan and the RCA. The Employer further authorizes the Director of Legislative and Information Services to submit forthwith a certified copy of this By-Law to the OMERS Administration Corporation.

11. Town of Ajax By-law 63-74 and By-law 6-75 are hereby repealed.

READ a first and second time this Twenty-seventh day of March, 2023.

READ a third time and passed this Twenty-seventh day of March, 2023.

_____
Mayor

_____
D-Clerk

THE CORPORATION OF THE TOWN OF AJAX

BY-LAW NUMBER 63-74

A By-law to authorize participation in the Ontario Municipal Employees *Retirement System.*

WHEREAS pursuant to Section 14 of the Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement System Act, R.S.O. 1970, as amended, a municipality or local board may by by-law or resolution elect to participate in the Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement System and pay to the fund the total of the employer and employee contributions, and has all the powers necessary and incidental thereto;

NOW THEREFORE the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax (herein called the Employer) enacts as follows:

1. The Employer hereby elects to participate in the Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement System as of the first day of January, 1974 (herein called the effective date) and authorizes the Clerk to submit this election in writing by provision of a certified copy of this by-law, to the Secretary-Treasurer of the Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement Board.

2. Every employee of the Employer who on December 31, 1973 was employed by the Corporation of the Town of Ajax or the Corporation of the Village of Pickering and who was or was entitled to become a member of the Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement System on December 31, 1973 shall continue such membership or membership entitlement from January 1, 1974 while employed by the Employer.

3. Subject to clause 2, every person who becomes an employee of the Employer on or after the effective date if he is employed on a continuous full time basis shall, as a condition of his employment become a member of the System or if he is already a member resume his contributions to the System, on a day fixed by the Employer that is within twelve months after the day on which he became so employed.

4. The Treasurer of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax is hereby authorized to arrange for the deduction from the earnings of each employee who is a member of the System, the contributions required to be made by the member, and to remit such contributions together with the amounts required under the Act to be paid by the Employer, to the Secretary-Treasurer of the Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement Board, and to execute all necessary documents and to do such things as are necessary to carry out the intent of this by-law.

5. The Employer hereby certifies that employees who are engaged as firemen are entitled to retire at age 60.

READ a first time this Twenty-first day of January, 1974.

READ a second time this Twenty-first day of January, 1974.

READ a third time and finally passed this Twenty-first day of January, 1974.

Certified a true copy of By-law Number 63-74 as witness my hand and the Seal of the Corporation.

. . . . . .
Clerk

. . . . . .
Mayor

. . . . . .
Clerk

THE CORPORATION OF THE TOWN OF AJAX

BY-LAW NUMBER 64-74

A By-law to authorize participation of Councillors in the Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement System.

WHEREAS pursuant to section 14 of The Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement System Act, R.S.O., 1970, as amended, a municipality may, by by-law, elect to participate in The Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement System in respect of its Councillors and pay to the Fund the total of the employer and member contributions, and has all the powers necessary and incidental thereto;

NOW THEREFORE the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax (herein called the Employer) enacts as follows:

1. The Employer hereby elects to participate in The Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement System in respect of its Councillors as of the first day of January, 1974 (herein called the effective date) and authorizes the Clerk to submit this election in writing by provision of a certified copy of this By-law, to the Executive Director of The Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement Board.

2. Every person who, on the effective date, is a Councillor of the Employer shall become a member on the effective date.

3. Every person who becomes a Councillor after the effective date shall become a member on the date on which he becomes a Councillor.

4. The Treasurer of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax is hereby authorized to arrange for the deduction from the earnings of each Councillor who is a member of the System the contributions required to be made by the member and to remit such contributions together with the contributions required to be made by the employer to the Executive Director of The Ontario Municipal Employees Retirement Board, and to execute all necessary documents and to do such things as are necessary to carry out the intent of this by-law.

READ a first time this Twenty-first day of January, 1974.

READ a second time this Twenty-first day of January, 1974.

READ a third time and finally passed this Twenty-first day of January, 1974.

Certified a true copy of By-law Number 64-74 as witness my hand and the Seal of the Corporation.

. . . . . Clerk.

. . . . . Mayor

. . . . . Clerk

Town of Ajax Report

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Sarah Webster, Financial Analyst
Report #:	FIN-2023-06
Subject:	2022 Statement of Remuneration and Expenses for Members of Council and Council Appointees
Ward(s):	All
Date of Meeting:	March 20, 2023
Reference:	Section 284(1) of the *Municipal Act, 2001, S.O. 2001*

Recommendation:

That the 2022 Statement of Remuneration and Expenses for Members of Council and Council Appointees be received for information.

Background:

Section 284(1) of the *Municipal Act, 2001* states that:

"The treasurer of a municipality shall in each year on or before March 31 provide to the council of the municipality an itemized statement of remuneration and expenses paid in the previous year to:

a) Each member of council in respect of his or her services as a member of the council or any other body, including a local board, to which the member has been appointed by or on which the member holds office by virtue of being a member of council;

b) Each member of council in respect of his or her services as an officer or employee of the municipality or other body described in clause (a); and

c) Each person, other than a member of council, appointed by the municipality to serve as a member of any body, including a local board, in respect of his or her services as a member of the body."

Discussion:

Information concerning the Ajax Council appointees was obtained directly from Elexicon, Ajax Municipal Housing Corporation and the Library Board. For the Town's Advisory Committees, Anti-Black Racism Committee and Taskforce and two Business Improvement Areas, the information was available from the Finance Department's records.

The Downtown Ajax and Pickering Village Business Improvement Areas were dissolved in March 2022, as per by-law 19-2022.

The 2022 statement of remuneration and expenses is presented in Attachment #1.

Financial Implications:

None

Communication Issues:

None

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

N/A

Conclusion:

In accordance with the requirements of the *Municipal Act, 2001*, the attached statement has been prepared and submitted to Council by the March 31, 2023 deadline.

Attachments:

ATT-1: Statement of Remuneration & Expenses

Prepared by:

Sarah Webster – Financial Analyst

Submitted by:

Dianne Valentim, CPA, CGA – Director of Finance / Treasurer

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

Council Remuneration Report

Authorized under By-law 22-2022 and Policy 030 Elected Officials Compensation and Expenses

Table A - Members of Council

Member's Name	Remuneration/ Benefits	Travel Allowance	Communication/ Meeting Expenses	Education / Training	Total
S. Collier	$144,123.69	$14,831.00	$873.11		$159,827.80
M. Crawford	60,755.46	9,393.00	2,237.15		$72,385.61
S. Lee	60,755.46	9,393.00	2,485.47	360.56	$72,994.49
J. Dies	60,755.46	9,393.00	2,567.92	90.00	$72,806.38
R. Morin	60,734.48	9,393.00	494.52		$70,622.00
L. Bower	60,755.46	9,393.00	245.81		$70,394.27
Total	**$447,880.01**	**$61,796.00**	**$8,903.98**	**$450.56**	**$519,030.55**

Incoming member of Council elected November 28, 2022

N. Henry	4,700.16	722.54	1,200.00	534.24	7,156.94

2018 to 2022 outgoing member of Council

A. Khan *	59,785.78	8,778.87	966.72		69,531.37

* Includes 2022 severance payment

Table B - Ajax Council Appointees - Ajax Municipal Housing Corporation

Ajax Municipal Housing Corporation	
Member's Name	**Conferences**
Marilyn Crawford	-
Rob Tyler Morin	-
Total	**$0.00**

Table C - Ajax Council Appointees - Ajax Library Board

Ajax Library Board	
Member's Name	**Training / Meetings**
Sepelene Deonarine	$0.00
Marcela Killin	-
Eesha Chaudhry	-
Douglas Miller	169.50
Noel Green	-
Deborah McDougall	-
Sterling Lee	-
Rebecca Hayes	-
Matthew Tapscott	-
Sandy Taylor	-
Total	**$169.50**

Table D - Ajax Council Appointees - Pickering Village BIA

Pickering Village BIA*	
Member's Name	**Conferences**
Khari Gaynor	$0.00
Dora Hatzis	-
Iris Nicolaison	-
Katelyn Yuill	-
Marsha Jones Dooley	-
Erika Kalichman	-
Total	**$0.00**

Table E - Ajax Council Appointees - Downtown BIA

Downtown BIA*	
Member's Name	**Conferences**
Fredrica Walters	$0.00
Alnoor Mohamad	-
Mukhtar Mohammad	-
Akinyemi John	-
Precious Reeves	-
Total	**$0.00**

*The Downtown Ajax and Pickering Village Business Improvement Area's were dissolved in March 2022, as per by-law 19-2022.

Table F - Ajax Council Appointees - Committee of Adjustment

Committee of Adjustment	
Member's Name	**Honorariums**
Wasif Ahmed	$720.00
Mark Pawelek	650.00
Cecil R Ramnauth	650.00
Lori Roberts	615.00
Greg Whitfield	280.00
Total	**$2,915.00**

Table G - Ajax Council Appointees - Animal Services / Property Standards Committee

Animal Services / Property Standards Committee	
Member's Name	**Honorariums**
Jessica Black	$130.00
Lynda Foster	140.00
Tyler Oosterhuis	130.00
David Saunders	140.00
Total	**$540.00**

Table H - Ajax Council Appointees - Advisory Committees

Heritage Advisory Committee		Accessibility Advisory Committee	
Member's Name	**Conferences**	**Member's Name**	**Conferences**
Bruce Balsdon	$0.00	Lisa Bower	$0.00
Beverly Briggs	-	Kailey Danks	-
Neil Burnett	-	Sepelene Deonarine	-
Camille Graham	-	Barb Dowds	-
Paul Hébert	-	Rosanne Purnwasie	-
Ashmeed Khan	-	Kathreen Smith	-
Anderson Mendonca	-	Ray Smith	-
Pam Pryjma	661.79	Heather Steeves	-
Stephen White	-		
Jeff Wood	-		
Total	**$661.79**	**Total**	**$0.00**

Table I - Ajax Council Appointees - Compliance (Elections) Audit Committee

Compliance (Elections) Audit Committee	
Member's Name	**Honorariums**
Paul Jones	$0.00
Kelly Gravelle	-
Kalli Chapman	-
Joe Brown	-
Sachin Persuad	-
Gary Cohn	-
Richard Austin	-
Total	**$0.00**

Table J - Ajax Council Appointees - Elexicon Corporation

Elexicon Corporation			
Member's Name	**Remuneration**	**Training / Meetings**	**Total**
Shaun Collier	22,096.30	7,050.00	29,146.30
Total	**$22,096.30**	**$7,050.00**	**$29,146.30**

Table K - Ajax Council Appointees
Anti-Black Racism Committee and Taskforce

Anti-Black Racism Taskforce		Anti-Black Racism Taskforce Nominating Committee	
Member's Name	**Remuneration**	**Member's Name**	**Remuneration**
Brenton Alleyne	90.00	Mariska Thomas	906.25
Janelle Benjamin		Dane Lawrence	471.25
Talisa Boland		Pauline Vassell	505.00
Fabian Dehaney	393.75	Eleanor McIntosh	
Monica Edwards	483.75		
Keishia Facey			
Danielle James	496.25		
Jaeden Lawton			
Sammy Njobi	446.25		
Camile Perry	375.00		
Sonia Ellis Seguin	240.00		
Nickidia Thompson			
Keirah Vandusen	458.75		
Kevin Vieneer	285.00		
Total	**$3,268.75**	**Total**	**$1,882.50**

Town of Ajax Report

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Chris Walker
Report #:	OES-2023-09
Subject:	Contract Award – AVL & Dashcams Award
Ward(s):	All
Date of Meeting:	March 20, 2023
Reference:	P22014 – 1031611 (ITS004) GPS & Dashcams

Recommendation:

1. **That Council award the contract for AVL Dashcam Solution, to DiCan in the amount of $710,523.15 (inclusive of all taxes).**

2. **That Council approve funding of $396,840.52 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 1031611 from the Capital Contingency Reserve**

3. **That Council authorize Staff to renew the annual licensing, maintenance and support contract for an additional four, one-year periods, pending an analysis and satisfactory performance review at the anniversary date of the contract, in the estimated amount of $649,035.84 (inclusive of all taxes).**

Background:

This award is for the purchase, installation, and maintenance of an Automatic Vehicle Locator (AVL) Solution and vehicle and equipment mounted cameras to further support the management of our town services including various fleet assets. This technology will improve data collection quality, reliability and accessibility.

In our current state, AVL devices are installed on a large number of Town vehicle and equipment assets. The AVL technology has been installed for an estimated 13 years.

With the advancement of this technology over the course of time, this solution will replace the Town's current AVL system and expand to include various camera configurations and will enable to the town to decommission the existing technology.

The AVL solution coupled with the mounted cameras on various vehicles and equipment, will provide the Town with real data such as location of vehicles, speed, direction and route progress status and historical reports. In addition, this technology has expanded to include capturing real data that will assist Fleet in making day to day and long-term decisions regarding the utilization and maximization of the Fleet.

This modern system will assist the town with improving its operational and municipal works functions while the vehicle mounted cameras will support staff safety, security of vehicles and provide a resource for driver education.

Discussion:

With the advancement of technology, this system will permit the town to take a strategic, evidence-based approach to improving their work planning and responsiveness to internal customers, residents and manage employee and driver behaviour. Better data is needed to inform decision-making in the following areas:

Risk Management

A reliable and advanced GPS system coupled with a camera system fixed to various fleet assets will provide the needed data to understand the town's position as a result of claims against the town. Real and reliable data will assist in defending these claims.

Defending the town's position with evidence-based data and demonstrating its compliance with the Minimum Maintenance Standards (MMS Ont.239/02) and other guiding legislation is crucial in order to mitigate court costs as well as ensure that the Town can uphold its services levels.

Customer Service

The town routinely receives calls regarding the various services provided which regularly require staff to investigate and confirm the information provided by the public. Real and reliable GPS and camera data will enable the town to address additional inquiries from the public in a more direct manner and in less time.

Service Levels

Town staff are required to strive to ensure that service levels are maintained for various services provided. To reliably validate the service levels of various services and to seek continuous improvements and efficiencies within the delivered services, reliable data from these technologies will assist with this ongoing monitoring.

Salt Management

The technology can directly connect to the material distribution system in each winter truck that is equipped with a distribution system. The AVL will report material application rates and material usage data in one location that can be analyzed to ensure effectiveness and to seek efficiencies to minimize environmental impacts and costs.

Fleet Utilization

In order to continue to effectively manage and maximize the fleet of vehicles and equipment that are utilized to deliver the services provided by the town it is crucial to ensure that decisions are made using evidence-based data. The AVL Technology is plugged directly into the equipment to retrieve live data such as but not limited to real mileage, hours, idle time, fuel flow, mechanical error code, and safety alerts. This data will assist Fleet Services by strengthening the preventative maintenance program and

ensure that each vehicle and equipment is being utilized adequately. This technology is compatible with retrieving similar reading from electric vehicles.

Driver Training and Education

The town continues to build its training program to ensure the safety of all its employees and the public as well as to ensure it is maintaining compliance with applicable legislation such as CVOR (Commercial Vehicle Operator Registrations). Having a modern AVL system that is plugged into the vehicle computer can track who is driving a vehicle at a given time, level of braking or acceleration applied, the speed the vehicle is travelling and seat belt on or off as examples . This data can be analyzed to profile driver behaviour and knowledge about the errors can assist in preventative maintenance efforts and more precise and targeted driver education.

AVL System Procurement Process

The Town undertook both Request for Information (RFI) and Request for Proposal (RFP) documents for this project. RFI documents were issued in early 2022 for the purpose of gathering information about AVL and dashcam products on the market, obtaining ballpark cost estimates and shaping the Town's RFP requirements. The RFI documents contained approximate numbers of vehicles and dash cameras needed to enable vendors to submit complete bids.

Request for Proposal (RFP) documents were posted to the Town's eBidding platform and 18 prospective Proponents registered for the opportunity with Proposals being received from 3 of these, prior to the closing on November 10, 2022. Listed below is a summary of the Proposals received:

NAME OF PROPONENTS
DiCAN Inc.
GoFleet Corporation
Samsara Technologies Canada ULC

The following is the Proposal Evaluation Criteria used for this RFP:

MANDATORY SUBMISSION REQUIRMENTS (firms not meeting the mandatory requirements may be deemed non-responsive & subject to rejection)		
Insurance	Pass/Fail	
WSIB	Pass/Fail	
EVALUATION CRITERIA	**WEIGHTED POINTS**	**TOTAL AVAILABLE POINTS**
QUALIFICATIONS & EXPERIENCE		
Company History, Background, Qualifications & Experience	15	25
Project Staffing, Resource Qualifications & Experience	10	
QUALITY OF PROPOSAL SUBMISSION		
Quality & Completeness of Entire Bid Submission	5	5
APPROACH & METHODOLOGY		

Demonstrated Alignment of Proposed Solution to Business Requirements, Technical Requirements, Security Requirements & AODA Requirements (External Portal Only)	25	50
Proposed Work Plan, Implementation Methodology/Solution & Project Implementation Methodology	5	
Ability to Meet Estimated Time Frames & Deadlines	5	
Warranty, Support & Maintenance	10	
Staff Allocation	5	
PRICING		
Cost Effectiveness of the Proposal		20
TOTAL POINTS		100
INTERVIEW (if applicable)		50
GRAND TOTAL		150

An Evaluation Committee, made up of Operations and Technology & Innovation staff, reviewed all the proposals received. Based on the evaluation criteria, specified in the RFP document, DiCan Inc. was the highest scoring proponent and met all the needs of the Town, although DiCan's bid exceeds the original capital project budget estimate. An over-budget approval is being sought due to the following reasons:

Economic Outlook
Technology hardware costs have increased owing to high inflation and other factors since the original capital budget request was submitted in 2021.

Scope Changes
The original capital budget used ballpark estimates of the number of vehicles and number of dashcams needed per vehicle. The number of vehicles and dashcams were increased in the RFP based on information acquired from vendor RFI bids and subsequent refinement of requirements.

Another change introduced in the RFP document was the need for the AVL solution to have a singular portal that controls both the GPS and dashcam functions instead of having one portal control the AVL and another separate portal controlling the vehicle dashcams. A single portal creates a seamless, more secure and efficient user experience for Town staff.

Financial Implications:

Capital Account No. 1031611.5830 – AVL Dashcam Solution

Approved Capital Budget		$275,000.00
Contract (net of HST rebate)	$639,848.11	
Contingency (5%)	$ 31,992.41	
		$671,840.52
Over Budget		($396,840.52)

The contingency will be used for unforeseen project scope changes, technology hardware and infrastructure needs.

Additional funding, not to exceed $396,840.52, will be allocated from the Capital Contingency Reserve.

The Capital Detail Sheet is attached for information.

Communication Issues:

None.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

The Top 22 Actions of the strategic plan include:

- Implement route optimization software to support and improve winter control initiatives.
- Develop a Fleet Utilization Strategy, and continue to invest in green assets, equipment and technology.

Strategic Focus Area: Investing in our Community

Goal: to modernize existing municipal infrastructure and other assets.

Actions:

- Review the Salt Management Plan to optimize existing practices and operation.
- Implement Route Optimization software to support and improve winter control activities.

Strategic Focus Area: Leading in our Community

- Action: to Develop a Fleet Utilization Strategy, and continue to invest in green assets, equipment and technology.

Conclusion:

It is the recommendation of staff that DiCan Inc. be awarded the contract for GPS & Dashcams, being the highest scoring Proponent.

Attachments:

ATT-1: Capital Detail Sheet

Prepared by:

Chris Walker – Manager of Technology & Innovation

Submitted by:

Dave Meredith – Director of Operations & Environmental Services

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

TOWN OF AJAX

2022 CAPITAL BUDGET / 2023-2031 LONG RANGE CAPITAL FORECAST

DETAIL SHEET

Department	Legislative & Information Services	**Project Initiation Year**	2022
Section	Technology & Innovation		
Project Name	**AVL - Dashcam Solution**		
Submitted By	Chris Walker, Manager, Technology and Innovation		
Start Year	2022		
Project Number	1031611		

PROJECT DESCRIPTION / JUSTIFICATION

Scope: The Operations Department maintains fleet equipment and has lacked the data required to take a strategic evidence based approach to improving their decision making, work planning and responsiveness to employee and driver behaviour. This project will involve upgrading of GPS hardware and software and adding dashcams to fleet vehicles. Procurement, setup, testing and support will be key components of this project.

Rationale: The Town of Ajax is in need of an upgrade to its current GPS solution in the Town's vehicle fleet. The current hardware is dated and does not provide the data needed to make informed decisions. Dashcams encourage safer driving and provide an unbiased video recording which can be used as evidence in an insurance claim. Dashcams aid in protecting the safety of Town staff as well as encourage safe driving habits through evidence based data collected to develop driver training programs. In order to become more proactive and provide a stronger legal position to legislative compliance and insurance claims, better data is needed to inform decision making in the following areas:

- Risk Management: Adherence to regulations such as Minimum Maintenance Standards and Occupier's Liability Act
- Worker Safety: interactions with the public (i.e. By-Law and Snow Plow Operators)
- Worker Health and Safety: Fleet Driver behaviour training and coaching
- Winter Control: work planning, decision making, measurement of services and adherence to service levels and create accurate data for business decisions
- By-Law Services: GPS for route optimization
- Fleet optimization, work planning and scheduling
- Environmental Services: work planning, measuring of service standards and evidence against claims
- Fire & Emergency Services: better work planning, route optimization, safety and responsiveness to emergencies
- Customer Service: able to defend our service level actions in the field

Reference: GPS Dashcam Hardware and Software Assessment, 2020 Information Technology Strategic Plan
Schedule: January 2022 - November 2022

EXPENDITURES / FUNDING

	2022	2023	2024	2025-2031	Total
Total Expenditures	**275,000**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**275,000**
Insurance Reserve Fund	**275,000**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**275,000**
Total Funding	**275,000**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**275,000**
Annual Operating Costs	***47,700***	**-**	**-**	**-**	***47,700***

Town of Ajax Report

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Lindsay Sinclair, Supervisor of Facility Capital Projects & Asset Management
Report #:	OES-2023-01
Subject:	**Contract Award – Ajax Cricket Site Improvements**
Ward:	3
Date of Meeting:	March 20, 2023
Reference:	RFT No. T23002 Ajax Cricket Field Improvements RFS No. S23002 –Contract Administration ~ Ajax Cricket Field Improvements Capital Account No: 1020111.5850/4108

Recommendation:

1. **That Council award the contract for Ajax Cricket Field Improvements, to Latitude 67 Limited in the amount of $4,367,463.56 (inclusive of all taxes).**

2. **That Council award the contract for Contract Administration ~ Ajax Cricket Field Improvements, to Landscape Planning Limited in the amount of $67,800.00 (inclusive of all taxes).**

3. **That Council approve funding of $1,362,793.78 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 1020111 from Canada Community Building Fund.**

Background:

The Ajax Cricket Site is located at the north-east corner of Clements Road West and Monarch Ave and has a land area of approximately 6 acres complete with a clubhouse and cricket field. The site consists of an oval shaped field with an artificial wicket in the center, practice batting cages, a storage garage and a parking lot along the south border accessed by Clements Road West. The existing clubhouse was constructed in 1980 with an addition in 1990 and is approximately 2,500 sq.ft. The building is a one storey ‘A’ frame structure with a large hall, recreation room, small kitchen, washrooms and change rooms with showers.

In 2019, the Town submitted a grant application to the Provincial Investing in Canada Infrastructure Program (ICIP). The Town was successful in securing this grant and the project will receive partial funding for upgrades to the cricket field and clubhouse as outlined in the application.

In 2021, a structural condition assessment was undertaken to determine the current condition of the aging clubhouse. The assessment determined the clubhouse is in poor condition and requires greater repair expenditures than the estimated cost to demolish and construct a new

building. Based on the condition assessment the Town has completed the detailed design for the demolition and construction of a new field house facility to serve the cricket site.
In 2022, the Town retained a consultant to complete the detailed design for the replacement of the field house building and the cricket field improvements. These improvements include:

Landscape Work

- Full removal, re-grading, re-sodding, and realignment of the existing cricket field
- Installation of new artificial wicket complete with concrete base
- Installation of a new practice wicket batting cage
- Site landscaping
- Netting along the woodlot
- Batters eye guards
- Fencing along Monarch Ave
- Spectator seating
- Field lighting, irrigation, and drainage
- Replacement and expansion of the existing parking lot and site lighting
- Walkways for all street and parking lot connections

Field House Construction

- Demolition of the existing clubhouse building
- Construction of a new field house building, approx. 2,200 sq.ft., consisting of public washrooms, Home & Away change rooms, a referee change room, small indoor viewing area and mechanical/electrical/janitorial space.
- Construction of a new storage building to house the field maintenance equipment.

Discussion:

The Town undertook a Request for Pre-Qualification [RPQ No. PQ2203] for Pre-Qualification Landscape Contractors ~ Cricket Site Improvements in June 2022 to cover Ajax Cricket Field Site Improvement requirements. This RPQ resulted in the appointment of 3 pre-qualified Bidders.

Request for Tender (RFT) documents were posted to the Towns' eBidding platform, and the 3 pre-qualified bidders were invited to register for the opportunity. Of the invited bidders 3 registered for the opportunity with bids being received from 3 of these, prior to the closing on January 20, 2023.

Upon review of the 3 bids received, 1 of the submissions was found to be non-compliant and therefore cannot be considered in the award. Listed below is a summary of the bids considered:

NAME OF BIDDER	TOTAL TENDER AMOUNT
Latitude 67 Ltd.	$ 4,367,463.56
Rutherford Contracting Ltd.	$ 4,647,688.63

Financial Implications:

1020111 - Cricket Improvements

Canada Community-Building Funding $848,500.00

ICIP Grant Funding	$2,333,300.00	
Approved Capital Budget		$3,181,800.00
Previous Awards/Expenditures		
Region of Durham (Water Testing)	$467.20	
Durham EHS (OD126083)	$1,012.51	
IRC (OP124733)	$8,496.96	
Landscape Planning (OP124941)	$141,115.68	
		$151,092.35
Available Budget		$3,030,707.65
Estimated Awards		
Contract Award (net of HST rebate)	$3,933,036.21	
Contract Award Contingency (10%)	$393,303.62	
Contract Administration (net of HST rebate)	$61,056.00	
Contract Administration Contingency (10%)	$6,105.60	$4,393,501.43
Over Budget		($1,362,793.78)

A 10% contingency has been identified to ensure sufficient funding is available to address unforeseen issues that can be encountered during construction.

Staff have reviewed the bid submission and while it is higher than anticipated, the cost of labour and materials have increased significantly since 2019, when the original funding application was made. Staff have completed a line-by-line comparison of the construction cost estimate and the bid submission. The results of the analysis revealed several divisions of the contract that have costs greater than the estimate, these divisions include:

- Site servicing, drainage, and grading work
- Field irrigation
- Specialty Systems (batters eye screens, safety netting, site furniture)
- Overall building related works – replace versus renovate (staff completed a detailed analysis comparing costs of each option, and trying to salvage the existing building would not result in financial savings)
- Addition of a storage building to house all site maintenance equipment.

Additional funding, not to exceed $1,362,793.78, will be allocated from the Canada Community-Building Fund – CCBF through the Capital Account Closing Report.

The current Purchasing By-Law allows for purchases through negotiations, under certain conditions, more specifically, “where, at the discretion of the Department Head, in consultation with the Manager of Purchasing, it is deemed to be in the best interest of the municipality to negotiate with vendors.”

It is in the best interest of the Town to single source the Contract Administration to Landscape Planning Limited as they have completed the detailed design and are familiar with the project requirements.

Contract commencement is March 6, 2023, and completion is expected by Sept 30, 2023.

Communication Issues:

The construction of the site improvements and new field house will commence in early Spring 2023 with completion by Sept 2023. There will be project signs posted at the site as required by the ICIP grant and the Canada Community-Building Fund. The Town will have construction information available and updated regularly on our Construction Projects webpage and social media platforms.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

This report aligns with the following section of the 2018-2022 Strategic Plan – Stronger Together:

Focus Area:	Connecting our Community
Goal 3:	Fostering a sense of place and celebrating our history
Goal 4:	Creating opportunities to foster a welcoming and inclusive community
Goal 5:	Promoting a range of programs, services, and supports for all ages and abilities
Focus Area:	Investing in our Community
Goal 3:	Building new municipal infrastructure
Goal 4:	Modernizing existing municipal infrastructure and other assets
Goal 6:	Enhancing the beauty and appeal of the Town

Conclusion:

It is the recommendation of staff that Latitude 67 Limited be awarded the contract for the Ajax Cricket Field Improvements project, being the lowest bidder meeting the minimum specifications.

It is also the recommendation of staff that Landscape Planning Limited be awarded the contract to complete contract administration services as a single source purchase.

Attachments:

ATT-1: Cricket Site Improvement – Rendered Site Plan & 3D Elevation

ATT-2 Capital Detail Sheet

Prepared by:

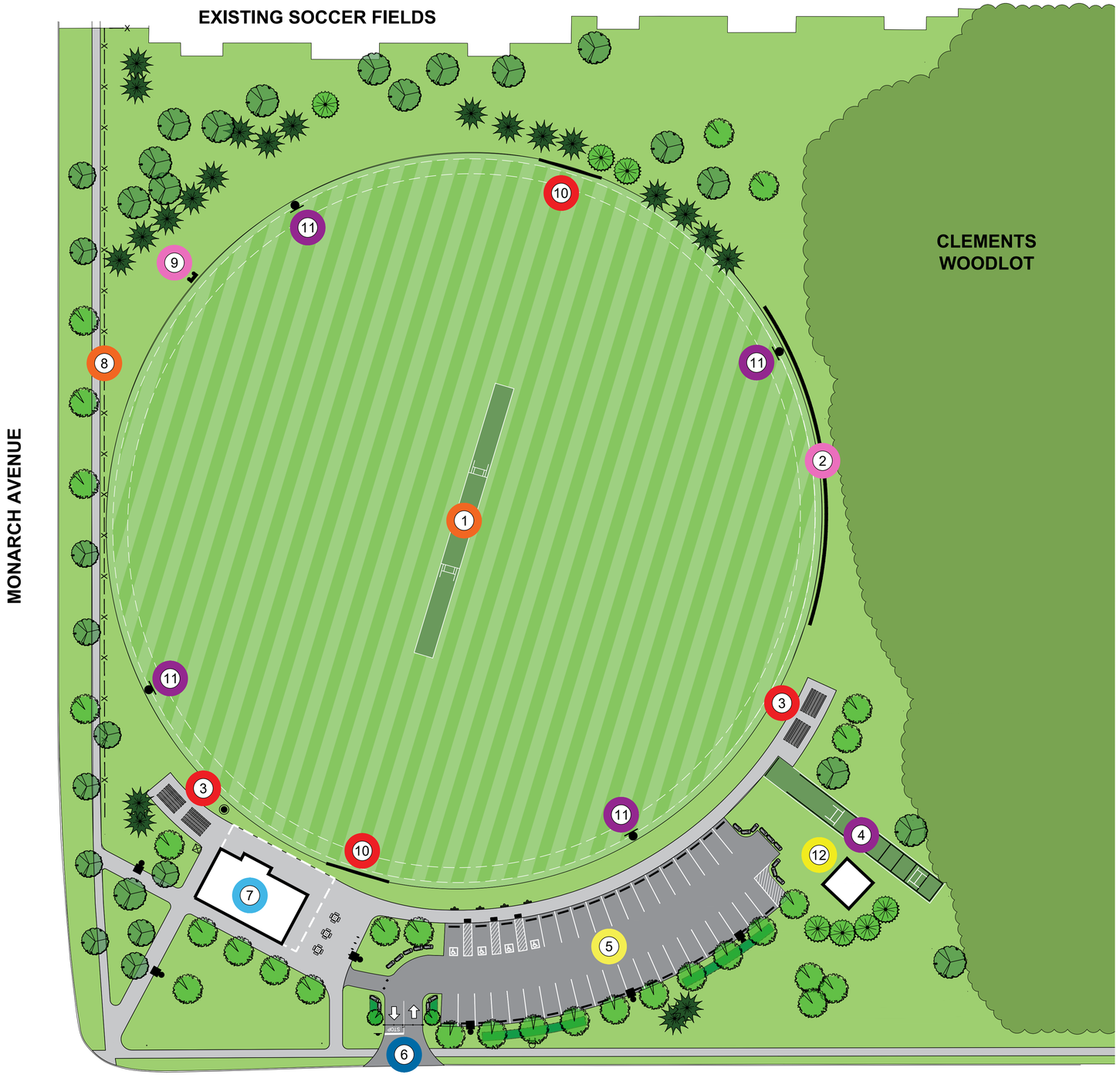
Lindsay Sinclair - Supervisor of Facility Capital Projects & Asset Management

Submitted by:

Dave Meredith - Director of Operations & Environmental Services

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer



LEGEND

- CONCRETE
- ASPHALT
- CRICKET FIELD
- SOD
- ARTIFICIAL TURF
- PLANT BED
- PROPOSED TREES
- EXISTING TREES TO REMAIN

KEYS

1. CRICKET WICKET
2. BARRIER NETTING
3. BLEACHERS
4. PRACTICE WICKET
5. PARKING - 4 ACCESSIBLE STALLS
   34 STANDARD STALLS
6. PARK SIGNAGE & GATE
7. CLUBHOUSE & PLAZA
8. CHAIN LINK FENCE
9. FUTURE SCOREBOARD
10. BATTER'S EYE
11. CRICKET PITCH LIGHTS
12. MAINTENANCE / STORAGE BUILDING

Town of Ajax By the Lake

landscape planning
LANDSCAPE ARCHITECTS

NORTH

1:400

AJAX CRICKET FIELD
MASTER PLAN

FEBRUARY 1, 2023

AJAX CRICKET FIELD, PAVILION & STORAGE BUILDINGS

615 MONARCH AVENUE, AJAX, ON



01 rendered 3D model
SCALE | NTS

TOWN OF AJAX

2022 CAPITAL BUDGET / 2023-2031 LONG RANGE CAPITAL FORECAST

DETAIL SHEET

Department	Operations & Environmental Services	**Project Initiation Year**	2021
Section	Building Maintenance		
Project Name	**Cricket Improvements**		
Submitted By	Ray Ford, Building Maintenance Manager		
Start Year	2021		
Project Number	1020111		

PROJECT DESCRIPTION / JUSTIFICATION

Scope: Staff are proposing the following repairs and upgrades to the cricket field infrastructure:
- Removal and replacement of the existing batting cages and the existing cricket pitch
- Installation of fencing, seating and site furniture
- Improvements to existing parking lot
- Landscaping improvements

Staff are proposing the following repairs and upgrades to the cricket clubhouse building:
- Removal of designated substances
- Repairs to the existing structure based on the structural assessment report
- Removal and replacement of the existing roof and repairs to the roof structure
- Building envelope upgrades including doors, cladding and windows
- Interior upgrades including washrooms, change facilities, flooring, drywall, painting, kitchen renovation and layout modifications to meet applicable building code and accessibility requirements

Staff will retain a consultant to complete the detailed design and contract documents.

Rationale: The Ajax Cricket Club is located at 615 Monarch Ave, south of the Ajax Community Centre and artificial soccer fields. The site consists of a land area of approximately 265,000 sq.ft. which includes a cricket field with spectator stands, a parking lot, two batting cages, a storage garage and a clubhouse building.

The clubhouse building was constructed in 1980 with an addition in 1990. The building consists of a one storey 'A' frame structure with a large hall, recreation room, small kitchen and change rooms with showers and washrooms. The cricket field consists of an artificial cricket pitch in the center of the oval shaped field. There are batting cages and a storage garage in the south-east corner of the lot and a parking lot along the south border of the site accessed by Clements Road West. The clubhouse building has undergone very little maintenance since construction and as such requires various repairs to ensure the building is safe.

Reference: N/A

Schedule: Detail design approved in 2021 ($200,000); Construction 2022 ($2,981,800)

EXPENDITURES / FUNDING

	2022	2023	2024	2025-2031	Total
Total Expenditures	**2,981,800**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**2,981,800**
Canada Community-Building Fund	**795,200**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**795,200**
Government Grants	**2,186,600**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**2,186,600**
Total Funding	**2,981,800**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**2,981,800**

Town of Ajax Report

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Dylan Quigley, Interim Supervisor of Fleet and Inventory Services
Report #:	OES-2023-05
Subject:	**RFT No. T23003 – Municipal Vehicles ~ Brine Truck with Snowplow**
Ward(s):	All
Date of Meeting:	Monday, March 20, 2023
Reference:	RFT No. T23003 – Municipal Vehicles ~ Brine Truck with Snowplow Capital Accounts # 23090322

Recommendations:

1. **That Council award the contract for Municipal Vehicles ~ Brine Truck with Snowplow, to Premier Truck Group Inc. in the amount of $615,595.75 (inclusive of all taxes);**

Background:

On December 12, 2022, this vehicle received pre-budget approval within the 2023 Capital Budget.

This approval consists of the purchase of one (1) heavy duty brine truck, with snow plowing capabilities, to support the service delivery for Operations and Environmental Services' Winter Maintenance Program and provide other seasonal support within the department.

In 2018, the Town conducted a Development Charge Background Study to understand future capital needs and related long term asset needs with respect to transportation growth, among other areas. Within this study, an additional brine truck was identified to address the anti-icing (brine) application in response to growth experienced within the Town of Ajax in recent years. Specifically, this growth was related to new roadways and the reclassification of roadways due to an increase in the amount of vehicular traffic.

Under the Minimum Maintenance Standards (MMS) Ont. Reg. 239/02 the Town is required, when practical, to take a proactive approach to address roadway conditions by impending winter weather. The anti-icing (brine) program is designed to provide a cost-effective proactive approach to treating the roadway network with a general focus on arterial and collector roadways.

This brine truck is intended to be dedicated to a work plan within the Operations and Environmental Services sections. In addition to supporting winter control and to maximize the utilization of this truck, the brine tank can be utilized as a larger capacity water tank within the other seasons.

The brine truck is designed with a roll-off type system with the intent to expand the use and full utilization of the truck over time. Future roll-off attachments may include, but are not limited to a flat bed, dumpster bin, chipper box, dump body, etc. This vehicle is expected to provide year-round support for Operations and Environmental Services.

Discussion:

Request for Tender (RFT) documents were posted to the Towns' eBidding platform and six (6) prospective bidders registered for the opportunity with bids being received from one (1) of these, prior to the closing on February 3, 2023. Listed below is a summary of the bids received:

NAME OF BIDDER	TOTAL TENDER AMOUNT
Premier Truck Group	$615,595.75

Financial Implications:

Capital Account No. 23090322 - RFT No. T23003 – Municipal Vehicles ~ Brine Truck with Snowplow

Approved Capital Budget		$650,000.00
Contract (net of HST rebate)	$554,363.04	
Available Budget		$95,636.96

The Capital Detail Sheet is attached for information.

Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

The replacement and additions of pickup trucks aligns with the following section of the Strategic Plan:

Focus Area: Investing in our Community
Goal 4: Modernizing existing municipal infrastructure and other assets

Conclusion:

It is the recommendation of staff that Premier Truck Group Inc. be awarded the respected contract to supply and deliver the identified vehicle.

Attachments:

ATT-1: 23090322 Brine Truck w/Plow

Prepared by:

Dylan Quigley – Interim Supervisor of Fleet and Inventory Services

Submitted by:

Dave Meredith – Director of Operations and Environmental Service

Approved By:

Dianne Valentim – Director of Finance/Treasurer

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

TOWN OF AJAX

2023 CAPITAL BUDGET / 2024-2032 LONG RANGE CAPITAL FORECAST

DETAIL SHEET

Department	Operations & Environmental Services	**Initially budgeted in**	2023
Section	Fleet / Equipment Maintenance		
Project Name	**Brine Truck w/Plow**		
Submitted By	Dylan Quigley, Interim Supervisor Fleet & Inventory		
Start Year	2023		
Project Number	23090322		

PROJECT DESCRIPTION / JUSTIFICATION

Scope: This project includes an additional brine truck with plow and wing attachments to support Operations staff with providing proactive brine application.

Rationale: The purpose of this vehicle is to support snow removal operations and be specifically dedicated to the anti-icing (brine) program. In this configuration, the brine tank will mirror a water tank during the off season. As the Town has grown over the past few years, the arterial and collector road distance has also grown, with no equipment added to support anti-icing operations. A multi-use heavy duty dump truck, with a brine tank attachment and snow plowing capabilities, will further support the anti-icing program by continuing to meet service levels as the Town's Road network and traffic capacities continue to evolve. This will allow the Operations section to provide a more consistent, proactive approach to anti-icing arterial and collector roadways to meet all service level expectations and the Minimum Maintenance Standards, which govern this transportation program.

Reference: Future DC 2023 Background Study

Schedule: Specifications will be developed upon project approval. Tender documents will be issued in early January 2023 with the expectation for delivery of the new asset by year end 2023 or sooner

EXPENDITURES / FUNDING

	2023	2024	2025	2026-2032	Total
Total Expenditures	**650,000**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**650,000**
Development Reserve	**32,500**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**32,500**
Development Charges - 2018	**617,500**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**617,500**
Total Funding	**650,000**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**650,000**

Town of Ajax Report

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Cameron Richardson, Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change
Report #:	PDS-2023-06
Subject:	**Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics – Implementation Update**
Ward(s):	All
Date of Meeting:	March 20, 2023
Reference:	GGC – March 9, 2020 (Corporate Ban on Single Use Plastics) GGC – March 20, 2023 (Environmental Sustainability Projects and Programs – Status Update – PDS-2023-04) Council – March 28, 2022 (Environmental Sustainability Projects and Programs Update – PDS-2022-09) Motion of Council – September 16, 2019 – Single-Use Plastics Ban

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Recommendations:

1. **That the report to General Government Committee, dated March 20, 2023, entitled "Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics – Implementation Update" be received for information; and**

2. **That Council endorse a shift from external enforcement of the corporate ban on single-use plastics, referenced in Phases III and IV of the Corporate Ban on Single-use Plastics Implementation Plan, to encouraging behavioural changes through public education and engagement initiatives.**

1. Background:

In September 2019, Council directed staff to examine the feasibility of a corporate ban on unnecessary single-use plastics with consideration of how a ban would apply to Town facilities, operations, programs, and events.

In March 2020, Council approved the Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics Implementation Plan and corresponding actions. The corporate ban is being implemented in five distinct phases, each of which has key milestones to monitor implementation and success.

2. Discussion:

2.1 Roles and Responsibilities

To achieve zero plastic waste and eliminate plastic pollution requires an integrated management approach that involves stakeholders from all levels of government, plastic producers and manufacturers, and community members.

a.) *Government of Canada*

On October 7, 2020, Environment and Climate Change Canada (ECCC) released a *Science Assessment of Plastic Pollution* which presented a review of the occurrence and impacts of plastic pollution on human health. In addition, ECCC released the discussion paper *A Proposed Approach to Plastic Products to Prevent Waste and Pollution* on October 10, 2020. The discussion paper focused on banning or restricting certain single-use plastic items when supported by scientific evidence. These items include:

- Checkout bags
- Stir sticks
- Straws
- Cutlery
- Six-pack rings
- Food containers made from hard-to-recycle plastics

On May 1, 2021, ECCC announced the addition of plastic manufactured items as “toxic” under the *Canadian Environmental Protection Act* (CEPA). Immediately following the announcement, several companies in the plastics and petrochemical industry announced that they have formed a coalition to pursue legal action against the federal government.

In December 2021, the ECCC released the draft *Single-Use Plastics Prohibition Regulations* that would prohibit the manufacture, import, and sale of single-use plastic checkout bags, cutlery, foodservice ware made from or containing problematic plastics, ring carriers, stir sticks, and straws (with exceptions for flexible plastic straws for accessibility reasons) for public comment. The *Guidance for Selecting Alternatives to the Single-Use Plastics in the Proposed Single-Use Plastics Prohibition Regulations* was also released and is intended to help businesses transition away from the categories of single-use plastics listed in the proposed regulations. The commenting period was concluded on March 5, 2022 with the intent to finalize the regulations and bring the bans into force as early as late 2022.

In February 2022, the Federal government published a technical issues paper on the development of proposed regulations that would set minimum recycled content requirements for certain plastic manufactured items. The public consultation on these requirements concluded on March 14, 2022. The proposed regulation, which would also include labelling requirements for plastic items, are expected to be published in Fall 2023.

On June 20, 2022, the *Single-Use Plastics Prohibition Regulations* were enacted after multiple rounds of consultations. The regulations ban the manufacturing and export of the six most common single-use plastic items. The ban of exports on the items will not come into effect until 2025 to allow exporters ample time to find solutions and transition away from single-use plastic items. The regulations also maintain that non-conventional plastic alternatives (i.e., compostable plastic, bioplastic) for these items will also be banned because they are still non-recyclable and contribute to plastic waste. The implementation timeline is as follows:

- Ban on manufacturing and import of single-use plastic checkout bags, cutlery, foodservice ware, stir sticks, and straws (with exceptions for flexible plastic straws for accessibility reasons) six (6) months after regulations are registered (December 20, 2022).
- Ban on manufacturing and import of single-use plastic ring carriers 12 months after regulations are registered (June 2023).
- Ban on sale of single-use plastic checkout bags, cutlery, foodservice ware, stir sticks, and straws (with exceptions for flexible plastic straws for accessibility reasons) 18 months after the regulations are registered (December 2023).
- Ban on sale of single-use plastic ring carriers 24 months after the regulations are registered (June 2024).
- Ban on the manufacturing, import and sale for the purposes of export for all single-use plastic categories 42 months after the regulations are registered (December 2025).

In July 2022, the Government of Canada released two consultation papers to gather feedback on the development of labelling rules to improve the accuracy of recyclability and composability information found on plastic packaging and single-use items and on the establishment of a federal plastics registry that will require producers to report on plastics they manufacture. The public commenting period closed on October 7, 2022.

ECCC, as well as other federal departments and agencies, have committed to work with other levels of government to avoid duplication, monitor outcomes, expand the ban to other problematic items, and promote and ensure compliance.

b.) Province of Ontario

The Province of Ontario regulates and oversees waste management in Ontario, including recycling programs. The *Made in Ontario Environment Plan* commits to shifting to a waste management approach where producers are responsible for the waste generated from their products and packaging. This waste management approach is known as Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR). EPR describes the comprehensive responsibility that producers, importers, and brand owners have to reduce the environmental impact of their products and packaging. Under the EPR model, the responsibility extends across the entire product management lifecycle and encompasses waste reduction, recovery, recycling, and re-use. On June 3, 2021, the Province finalized the blue box regulations that will make producers responsible for blue box materials under the *Resource Recovery and Circular Economy Act, 2016*. The regulations also standardize what goes in the blue box across the province while at the same time removing the cost burden from municipalities. It was noted that the transition to EPR will start July 1, 2023 and be fully transitioned by December 31, 2025.

On April 19, 2022, without undergoing public consultation, the Ministry of the Environment, Conservation and Parks (MECP) released amendments to the blue box regulations and clarified that the province-wide collection and management system will be operated by Producer Responsibility Organizations (PROs). The amendments essentially grant producers independent decision-making power over how they collect and manage blue box materials to meet the diversion targets set by the regulation. The amended regulations continue Ontario's commitment to full EPR by shifting the entire financial and operational responsibility for end-of-life collection and management of materials to producers. All PROs were required to submit a plan to the province on July 1, 2022 to identify how the single-collection system will be implemented within the transition timelines. The new regulations will impact what every Ontarian puts in their blue box, who picks up those blue boxes, and how many of the items placed in the boxes are diverted from landfill.

The Province of Ontario will continue to work with municipalities to make the transition to EPR as seamless as possible. It is anticipated that Town of Ajax will be transitioned by July 1, 2024.

c.) Region of Durham

Waste management services have traditionally been delivered or coordinated by cities, towns, and regional authorities. These responsibilities comprise all areas of waste management including curbside/depot collection, sorting and separation operations, disposal facilities, and public education and outreach.

The Region of Durham has approved the *2022 to 2040 Long-Term Waste Management Plan* and the associated *2022 to 2026 Action Plan.* These plans focus on maximizing diversion of all waste, including single-use plastics, by developing innovative ways to use waste as a resource in a circular economy, providing enhanced resident education and engagement opportunities, and transitioning to EPR efficiently all while demonstrating leadership in sustainability.

On August 9, 2022, the Region of Durham sent a letter to MECP requesting a province-wide ban on plastic shopping bags. Town of Ajax Council endorsed this request.

d.) Town of Ajax

In March 2020, Town of Ajax Council approved the *Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics Implementation Plan* and associated action items. The implementation plan focuses on internal operations and a public awareness campaign to encourage local businesses, community partners, and residents to voluntary reduce their single-use plastics use and disposal.

2.2 Single-Use Plastics Definition

In 2020, as part of the Town's Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics, staff added a definition of single-use plastics while updating internal policies and guidelines. The Town of Ajax made amendments to the definition of single-use plastics to align with recent definitions used by other levels of government. The following definition will now be used:

Single-Use Plastics: Plastic items designed and intended to be used and disposed of after a single use or for a short period of use, including but not limited to straws, checkout bags, cutlery, and food containers made from hard-to-recycle materials.

2.3 Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics Implementation Progress

The following provides an update on the implementation progress and status of the actions identified in the Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics Five Phase Implementation Plan.

Action Items	**Status**
Phase I: Spring 2020-Fall 2020	
Implement the updated Green Event policy and corresponding guidelines with a focus on internal meetings and events	Complete
Develop signage and materials to support staff education initiatives by leveraging the Town's internal Green Team	Complete and Ongoing
Audit all meeting rooms and Town-owned event facilities to ensure three-stream receptacles are available for use	Complete
Tender and award a contract for a Vendor of Record for compostable serviceware to be accessed corporation-wide	Complete

Collect and donate all existing single-use plastic serviceware throughout Town facilities	In line with federal regulations, existing stock of single-use plastic serviceware will be utilized
Endorse a Council Charter on Plastic Waste Reduction, and subsequent public-facing communications campaign	Complete
Phase II: Winter 2021 – Spring 2021	
Work with Purchasing and each department to review all existing contracts and vendor relationships to determine capacity to comply with corporate ban on single-use plastics	Complete
Execute public education campaign for permit-holders, community partners, local businesses, and residents to voluntarily reduce their plastics consumption	Complete and Ongoing
Phase III: Summer 2021-Fall 2022	
Undertake research for best practices of ensuring compliance for permit-holders at Town-owned facilities, including an understanding of resource requirements	Complete
Analysis of the impact of the federal ban on single-use plastics on the corporation, and identification of any gaps in existing policies and procedures	Complete and Ongoing
Report to Council with recommendations for external compliance and enforcement, and any required amendments to existing policies and guidelines	Complete
Complete public consultations and education prior to the commencement of enforcement for permit holders at Town-owned facilities	In Progress
Phase IV: Winter 2023 – Spring 2023	
Update all relevant policies and guidelines to be specific to the different kinds of events and meetings that are held on Town-owned properties	Complete and Ongoing
Update all contracts and forms in each department to reflect the update policies	Not Started
Begin external enforcement of the corporate ban on single-use plastics	Recommended to not pursue
Phase V: Ongoing	
Continuous improvement for internal waste diversion and ongoing compliance with internal policies and procedures related to a corporate ban on single-use plastics	Ongoing
Participation in consultations related to the Town's ban held by other levels of government, including the Region of Durham, Province of Ontario, and the Government of Canada	Ongoing
Encouragement of residents, businesses, stakeholders, and community partners to reduce their usage of single-use plastics through leadership and public communications	Ongoing

2.4 Enforcement and Compliance

As part of Phase III of the implementation plan, Policy and Sustainability staff completed research of best practices and municipal case studies to encourage compliance of permit-holders at Town-owned facilities. Upon completion of that research, the following key considerations were identified:

- Policy, regulations, and legislation enacted by federal, provincial, and municipal governments can influence the public and have the power to change behaviours and generate new social norms.
- The most effective enforcement will come from federal and provincial regulations that target plastic producers, importers, and manufacturers.
- Several municipalities have introduced item-specific bans (i.e., plastic checkout bags) that were successfully challenged in court.
- Proper waste disposal throughout Durham Region is enforced through the *Durham Region Waste Management By-Law.*
- Engagement and education campaigns are very effective at raising public awareness about single-use plastics and proper waste disposal. Positive reinforcement is often more effective at initiating behavioural changes than punitive measures.
- The Town of Ajax can encourage litter reduction by continuing to be a leader in environmental sustainability.

Based on these key considerations, staff are recommending that external compliance with the Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics be encouraged through education and engagement initiatives to increase public awareness and change behaviours associated with single-use plastics use and disposal. Staff do not believe that enforcement through new by-laws with possible monetary fines will be effective in enacting positive behavioural change with residents, visitors, and business owners given that federal legislation will prevent the most problematic single-use plastic items from being manufactured or sold.

a) Public Awareness Campaign

The Town of Ajax continues to showcase leadership in the community to encourage positive behavioural change associated with single-use plastic consumption. These actions include:

- Becoming the first municipality in Durham Region to implement a corporate ban on single-use plastics.
- Endorsement of a Council Charter on Plastic Waste Reduction.
- Adoption of a five-phase Implementation Plan related to the corporate ban on single-use plastics.
- Hosting annual waste-related webinars and litter clean-ups as part of Ajax Green Living Days
- Working closely with Mind Your Plastic, a non-profit organization, to produce public education materials and plastic-reduction toolkits.

In addition to the items listed above, the Town of Ajax launched a comprehensive single-use plastics website with the goal of educating the public on zero-waste living, single-use plastic alternatives, federal and provincial government legislation, and other resources including information on how to organize a litter clean-up.

b) Facility Bookings

The facility booking process provides several points of contact for Town staff to utilize a standardized approach of engagement to promote both voluntary reduction of single-use plastics and use of potential alternatives to single-use plastics. The points of contact include:

- Customer Service Representatives (CSRs) – CSRs are the first point of contact/point of sale during the facility booking process. A standardized approach and training will be provided to all CSRs so that consistent information on reducing single-use plastics is given to the customer. Additional information, such as the Green Events Guideline and Plastic Reduction Toolkit, will be given to customers which will provide them with more information on the corporate ban as well as alternatives to single-use plastics.
- Facility Staff – Facility managers will be responsible for providing their staff with the knowledge and skills required to engage customers seen using single-use plastics. This is purely an education opportunity and a chance to engage groups about the Town's efforts to reduce the use of single-use plastics in the community. The federal ban on the manufacturing and sale of problematic single-use plastics should reduce the need to utilize this point of contact over time.
- By-Law Staff – Town By-law Officers will continue to enforce municipal by-laws related to proper waste disposal including the Clean Community By-Law. The federal ban on the manufacturing and sale of problematic single-use plastics should reduce the need to utilize this point of contact over time.

c) The 5Rs

Recently, the traditional 3Rs (Reduce, Reuse, Recycle) has been expanded to the 5Rs to communicate the steps needed to achieve a sustainable, zero-waste lifestyle. The 5Rs will be incorporated into all public education and communications related to any waste diversion program or campaign including educational websites, webinars, and events. The 5Rs include:

- Rethink – The first step to waste diversion is to rethink daily choices to eliminate unnecessary purchases, limit necessary purchases, and switch to more eco-friendly alternatives.
- Reduce – Limit the waste you produce.
- Reuse – Switch from using disposable or single-use items to items that are reusable or investigate opportunities to repurpose an item.
- Recycle – Following the first 3Rs, recycle items through proper methods.
- Recover – Utilize waste to recover any resources possible (i.e., Energy from Waste)

Engaging with residents to build an understanding of the 5Rs is one of the objectives identified within the Region of Durham's LTWMP.

3. Financial Implications:

While the Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics is a staff-led program that is not expected to require significant additional financial resources to achieve successful outcomes, the phased implementation could potentially result in requiring some additional resources.

Financial impacts related to this program, such as resources required to develop communication and education activities, will be brought forward to Council for consideration as part of future budgets, as needed.

Any unforeseen in-year financial impacts related to the phased implementation plan will be subject to the Town's Operating Budget Management Policy.

4. Communication Issues:

The Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics and associated implementation plan will continue to require substantial communication to both internal and external stakeholders. The Town will leverage its Corporate Communications group and Sustainability and Climate Change team to help educate and engage staff on single-use plastics and shared responsibilities. Externally, staff will focus on the promotion of the Town's leadership, sustainability undertakings, and successes to all relevant stakeholders including residents, community partners, local businesses, and other levels of government.

5. Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

This report aligns with the following sections of the 2018-2022 Strategic Plan – Stronger Together:

Focus Area:	Leading our Community
Goal:	Providing continued leadership in environmental sustainability
Action:	Increase community sustainability events and outreach to encourage proper waste education and urban green living

Focus Area:	Investing in our Community
Goal:	Enhance the beauty and appeal of the Town
Action:	Evaluate waste management practices at facilities, parks and open space

6. Conclusion:

Based on actions at all levels of government, Canada is moving towards the ban of single-use plastics and the shifting of plastic recycling costs to manufacturers and producers. These existing, pending, and future regulations will likely expand over time resulting in more plastic products and packaging being banned. This will result in an increased need for innovation and production in the area of reusable, recyclable, and biodegradable alternatives for businesses and consumers.

The Town of Ajax will continue to exemplify strong leadership and advocacy to fulfill our vision of becoming a sustainable community. Cross-collaboration between all departments, other municipalities, and government partners will be required to ensure that the Town of Ajax maximizes opportunities to increase waste diversion.

Attachments:

N/A

Prepared by:

Cameron Richardson – Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change – ext. 3229

Submitted by:

Geoff Romanowski, MCIP, RPP, CPT – Director, Planning and Development Services

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

Town of Ajax Report

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Mike Sawchuck, MCIP, RPP, CAHP Senior Planner
Report #:	PDS-2023-07
Subject:	**Pickering Village Community Improvement Plan: 2022 Façade Improvement Grant and Sign Grant Program Summary**
Ward(s):	1
Date of Meeting:	March 20, 2023
Reference:	Report to General Government Committee – February 12, 2022

Recommendation:

1. **That the report to the General Government Committee, dated March 20, 2023 entitled "Pickering Village Community Improvement Plan: 2022 Façade Improvement Grant and Sign Grant Program Summary" be received for information.**

1. Background:

In November 2013, Council approved the Pickering Village Community Improvement Plan (CIP), which initiated six financial incentive programs to stimulate improvements and future development within Pickering Village. The programs were divided into two broad categories: 1) Property Improvement Incentive Programs (which promote improvements to existing buildings via grants); and 2) Redevelopment Incentive Programs (which stimulate investment for redevelopment projects via tax rebates and fee exemptions/rebates).

This report summarizes the results of the 2022 Property Improvement Incentives Programs, which include the following initiatives:

- Façade Improvement Grant Program: Provides property owners with 50% matching grants to undertake restoration or improvement projects on their properties. Eligible projects include façade improvements to front, exterior side and interior side yards visible from the street; exterior accessibility upgrades; and structural and/or weather/water proofing repairs required to maintain overall building integrity.

- Sign Grant Program: Provides property owners with 50% matching grants to install new signage, repair existing signage and/or install appropriate exterior sign lighting (i.e. goose neck lighting) to improve property appearance and streetscapes.

Together, these initiatives serve to support property owners in preserving and enhancing the heritage character of Pickering Village as a distinct district within the larger Ajax community.

It should be noted that Redevelopment Incentives Programs under the Pickering Village CIP were suspended by Council on October 5, 2020. This report deals strictly with Property Improvement Incentive Programs, which remain active.

2. Discussion:

In 2022, the budget for the Pickering Village Property Improvement Incentive Programs (which includes both the Façade Improvement Grant and Sign Grant allocations) was $75,000. Similar to past years, there was substantial interest in the program early on in the year with staff discussing potential projects with ten separate property owners.

The Town entered into six funding agreements with six separate property owners. One of the properties, 103 Old Kingston Road, contained multiple frontages and qualified for an elevated level of funding ($30,000 maximum grant), while the other five qualified for the standard level of funding ($15,000 maximum grant). Together, the approved projects had a combined grant value of $69,370.00, which represented 92% of the $75,000.00 budget.

In the end, only three of the approved projects were completed as originally planned. The other three projects were either cancelled entirely or significantly reduced in scope due to contractor delays, lack of availability for required materials or unanticipated increases in project costs. As a result, the value of the Town's grant contribution in 2022 was reduced to $50,823.85, representing 68% of the approved budget. Despite the lessened contribution, the grants were able to support some significant projects representing a total project value of $194,335.39 ($50,823.85 contributed by the Town and $143,511.54 contributed by the applicants). Photos illustrating all funded property improvements are provided in Figures 1-5 and the successful projects from 2022 are summarized in Table 1.

The 2023 application window for priority properties (i.e. properties within the Heritage Conservation District and/or individually designated under Part IV of the *Ontario Heritage Act)* opened on January 15. All three of the projects that were cancelled or reduced in scope in 2022 have already reached out to the Town to confirm eligibility in this year's program. The application window for priority properties closed on March 15, and all other eligible properties are now able to submit their applications to the Town.



Before: Example of a wooden window sill showing and advanced state of deterioration.



After: Image showing new limestone window sill.

Figure 1: **497 Kingston Road West** **(Window Sill Replacements)**	**Town of Ajax Planning & Development Services**	Town of Ajax By the Lake



Before: Toppled monument on ravine edge.



After: Restored monument with stabilized base.



Before: Monument segmentation caused by lean.



After: Restored monument with stabilized base.



Before: Loose monuments leaning against trees.



After: Monuments added to central cairn.

Figure 2:
Elizabeth Street Cemetery
(Monument Stabilization and Restoration)

Town of Ajax Planning & Development Services



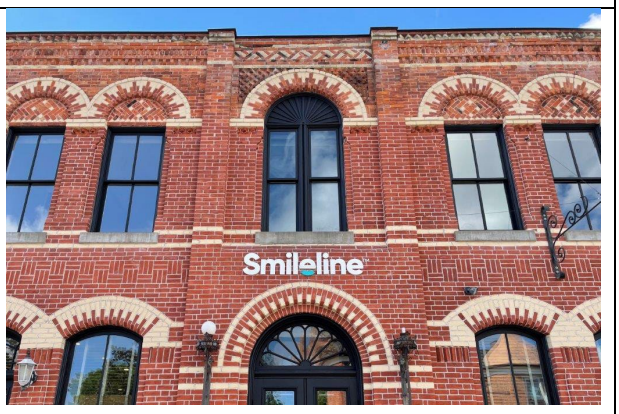
Before: View of main (north) façade



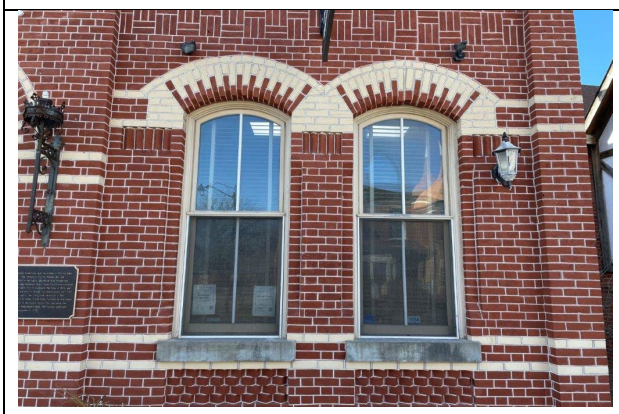
After: View of main (north) façade



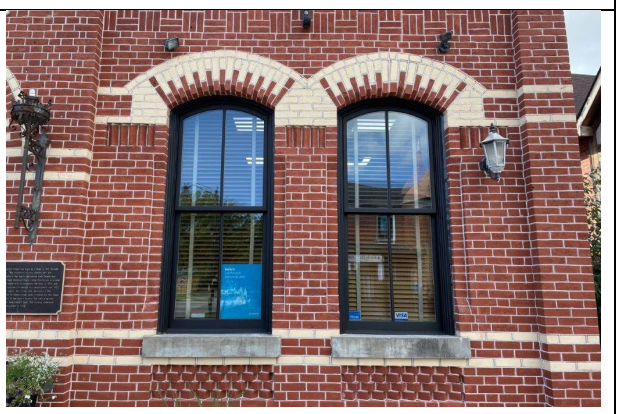
Before: View of details painted yellow and green.



After: View of details painted black.



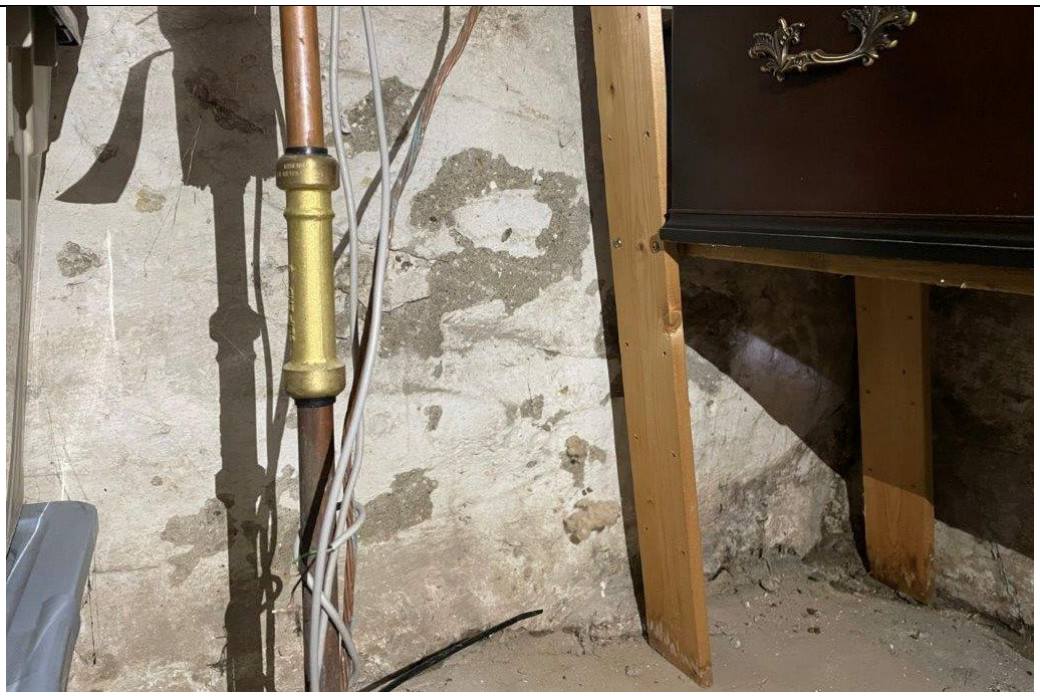
Before: Window obscured by exterior screen.



After: Repainted window with screen removed.

Figure 3:
103 Old Kingston Road
(Door and Window Repair and Glass Replacement)

Town of Ajax Planning & Development Services



Before: Exposed masonry basement foundation in the area of water infiltration issues.



After: View of impermeable membrane and new weeping tile cap, which feed the repaired sump pump.

Figure 4: **13 Elizabeth Street** **(Basement Waterproofing and Flood Remediation)**	**Town of Ajax Planning & Development Services**	Town of Ajax By the Lake



Before: Mortar joints are degraded and/or missing



After: Mortar joints are nearly flush with masonry



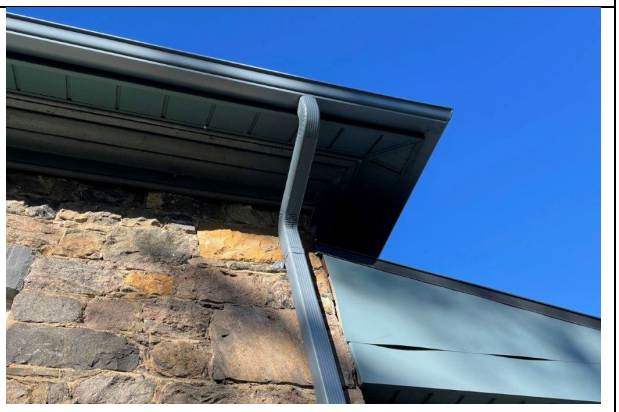
Before: Failing brick lintel above basement window



After: Restored, fully supported lintel



Before: Old, uneven and failing eaves/downspout



After: New, levelled and watertight eaves/downspout

Figure 5:
22 Linton Avenue
(Masonry Repairs, Repointing and Eaves Replacement)

Town of Ajax Planning & Development Services

Table 1 – Summary of 2022 Funded Projects

Address	Project Summary	Grant Value
497 Kingston Road West (Window Sill Replacements)	• Replace wooden window sills on original house with new limestone sills	$12,092.69
Elizabeth Street Cemetery (Monument Stabilization and Restoration)	• Stabilize and relocate (where required) existing leaning and toppled monuments • Other monument restoration and stabilization as required in 2020 order from By-Law	$6,875.00
103 Old Kingston Road (Door and Window Repair and Glass Replacement)	• Sand and make Dutchman repairs to windows, doors and all wooded details on the north façade • Repaint windows, doors and wooden details • Repair/replace glass window panes, where necessary	$22,331.16
13 Elizabeth Street (Basement Waterproofing and Flood Remediation)	• Patch holes in fieldstone foundation • Install interior weeping tile and connect to existing sump pit • Replace existing sump pump and associated plumbing	$3,250.00
22 Linton Avenue (Masonry Repairs, Repointing and Eaves Replacement)	• Remove old eavestrough and down spouts and install new 5” seamless aluminum eavestrough (with leaf guard) and downspouts in existing wedgewood blue colour; • Repoint masonry walls including grinding out failing mortar joints and application of new HLM 350 mortar • Rebuild falling brick lintel over basement window	$6,275.00

3. Financial Implications:

The funds budgeted and the total value of grants issued over the history of the Façade Improvement and Sign Grant Programs are as follows:

Table 2 – Program Funding and Allocation (2014 to Present)

Year	Amount Budgeted	Amount Spent
2014	$40,000.00	$39,475.00
2015	$75,000.00	$71,935.38
2016	$75,000.00	$32,637.50
2017	$75,000.00	$34,673.19
2018	$75,000.00	$44,075.82
2019	$75,000.00	$14,302.50
2020	$75,000.00	$36,865.93
2021	$75,000.00	$66,636.40
2022	$75,000.00	$50,823.85
Totals	**$640,000.00**	**$391,425.57**

The requested budget for the 2023 program remains unchanged from 2022 at $75,000. The 2023 Operating Budget was considered by the General Government Committee on February 16 and was ratified by Council on February 27, 2023.

4. Communication Issues:

Town staff will distribute program brochures at various Town events and will provide them directly to owners of properties within the CIP boundaries that have a demonstrated need for improvement. Staff will also continue to capitalize on opportunities to promote the programs as they arise.

5. Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

This report aligns with the following section of the 2018-2022 Strategic Plan – Stronger Together:

Focus Area:	Connecting Our Community
Goal:	Fostering a sense of place and celebrating our history
Action:	Celebrate our unique history and heritage (i.e. showcasing historical properties and artifacts)

6. Conclusion:

The Pickering Village Community Improvement Plan has been successful in providing financial incentives to local landowners that inspire them to invest in their properties. Funded projects help to preserve the character of existing heritage properties, beautify streetscapes, and generally improve the pedestrian experience for residents and visitors to Ajax's historic core. It is expected that interest in the program amongst property owners will continue throughout the program's duration.

Attachments: N/A

Prepared by:

Mike Sawchuck, MCIP, RPP, CAHP – Senior Planner

Submitted by:

Geoff Romanowski, MCIP, RPP, CPT – Director of Planning & Development Services

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

Town of Ajax Report

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Steven McReelis, Manager, Building Approvals & Chief Building Official
Report #:	PDS-2023-08
Subject:	**2022 Year End Building Permit Activity and 2023 Projection Report**
Ward(s):	All
Date of Meeting:	March 20, 2023
Reference:	N/A

Recommendation:

That the 2022 Year End Building Permit Activity and 2023 Projection Report be received for information.

1. Background:

Annually, Planning and Development Services prepares a report summarizing building permit activity. This report highlights activity occurring between January 1st through December 31st, 2022, and provides an outlook on activity anticipated in 2023.

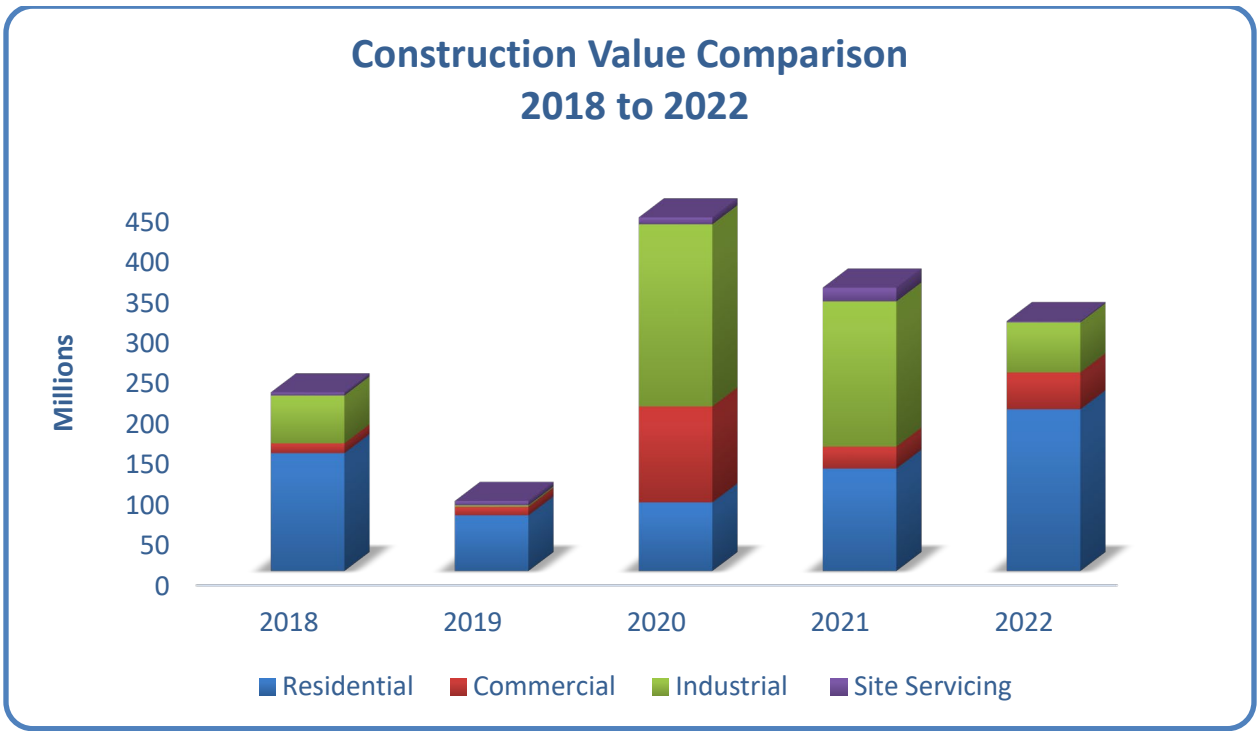
2. Discussion:

The following is a summary of the 2022 Year End Building Permit Activity:

- A total of 1,127 building permit applications were received in 2022, 27.1% (420) fewer than the 1,547 applications received in 2021.
- The total estimated construction value of building permit activity for 2022 was $308.2 million, which was down 11.8% from $349.4 million in 2021. Construction values are calculated for issued building permits only and not for permit applications that are in circulation.
- The total estimated construction value for residential building permits experienced a 57.9% increase, from $126.4 million in 2021 to $199.5 million in 2022.
- The 2022 forecast for new residential housing units (i.e. detached, semi-detached, townhouse, apartment) was 1,551, the actual number of units for which permits were issued was 904, representing 58.3% of the projected units.
- Building permits issued for secondary suites (accessory dwelling units) increased by 19.5%, from 149 permits in 2021 to 178 permits in 2022.

- Total estimated construction value for non-residential permits in 2022 was $108.7 million, this represents a decrease of 51.3% in comparison to the 2021 value of $223.0 million. The number of non-residential permits issued in 2022 was 180, compared to 286 in 2021.
- The 2022 forecast for new non-residential floor area was 111,401 m^2 (1,199,110 ft^2), the actual amount of new floor area for which permits were issued was 50,093 m^2 (539,196 ft^2). At the close of 2022 there was approximately 244,717 m^2 (2,634,112 ft^2) of new non-residential floor area in active circulation undergoing review or awaiting final approval.
- A total of 355 building permit applications were in circulation at the conclusion of 2022.

The following graph illustrates a comparison of construction values for the past five years. Note that commercial building permits include a broad range of uses permitted such as offices, restaurants, places of worship and public buildings. Buildings in the industrial category include buildings associated with assembling, fabricating, manufacturing, processing and repair or storage of goods and materials.



2023 Development Projections

Development in the residential sector is anticipated to increase slightly in 2023, construction on an estimated 1,074 new residential housing units (i.e. detached, semi-detached, townhouse, apartment) will commence in 2023.

The following are notable residential development projects that are projected to be approved for construction in 2023:

- Schlegel Villages Ajax (Phase 1) – 6-Storey, 192 Bed Long-Term Care Facility – 1401 Harwood Avenue North
- Lake Pointe at Discovery Bay (Phase 1) – 8-Storey, 163 Apartment Units – 255 Lake Driveway
- Spotlight Developments – 6-Storey, 111 Seniors Apartments – 290 Old Harwood Avenue

- Stafford Homes (Hunters Crossing) – 111 Townhome Units – 167 Hunt Street
- Kantanna Developments – 60 Stacked Townhome Units – 105 Rossland Road West
- Ajax Meadows – 27 Townhome Units – Rossland Road West at Harkins Drive
- Firmland (Cedar) Inc. – 20 Townhome Units – Cedar Street at Knapton Avenue

Non-residential development in 2023 will occur predominantly in the industrial sector, while there are a few other much awaited projects slated to commence construction. The following are notable non-residential development projects that are anticipated to be approved for construction in 2023:

- Pure Industrial – 112,800 m^2 Industrial Building – 537 Kingston Road East
- Annandale Industrial - 101,552 m^2 – 3 Industrial Buildings – 210 Church Street South
- Granite REIT – 4,625 m^2 Multi-Unit Industrial Addition – 555 Beck Crescent
- Sun City Business Park Phase 1 - Buildings A & B – 4,185 m^2 – Salem Road North of Rossland Road East
- Banquet Hall – 2-Storey, 4,085 m^2 – 630 Beck Crescent
- Fulson Industries Limited – 2,787 m^2 Industrial Building – 30 Pugsley Court
- 100307808 Canada Inc. – 2,150 m^2, Multi-Unit Industrial Building – 10 Chisholm Court
- Dilea Group Inc. – 1,810 m^2, Multi-Unit Industrial Building – 9 Barr Road
- Elm Ajax Plaza Inc. – 231 m^2 Multi-Unit Commercial Building – 605 Church Street North

3. Financial Implications:

None

4. Communication Issues:

None

5. Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

N/A

6. Conclusion:

Overall, in comparison to 2021, the Town realized declines in the number of applications received, permits issued, and construction values in 2022. However, it is important to note that 2021 recorded the highest number of permit applications received since 2006, and the highest number of permits issued since 2013. While the non-residential sector experienced the greatest reductions in 2022, the residential sector performance was similar to 2021 figures.

The development forecast for 2023 indicates an increase in the number new residential units approved for construction, while the non-residential sector is expected to rebound with a larger number of industrial building construction anticipated. As the Town transitions toward higher density residential development in the coming years, the residential sector numbers are expected to increase exponentially.

Attachments:

ATT-1: Town of Ajax Building Report – Year-To-Date – December 2022

Prepared by:

Steven McReelis MAATO, CBCO
Manager, Building Approvals & Chief Building Official

Submitted by:

Geoff Romanowski MCIP, RPP, CPT
Director, Planning & Development Services

Approved by:

Shane Baker
Chief Administrative Officer

TOWN OF AJAX BUILDING REPORT - YEAR - TO - DATE - DECEMBER 2022

TYPE OF PERMIT	DECEMBER 2022 (Year to Date)						DECEMBER 2021 (Year to Date)		
	Applications		Applications in Circulation (#)	Permits		Construction Value ($)	Applications Received (#)	Permits Issued (#)	Construction Value ($)
	Rec'd (#)	Change		Issued (#)	Change				
RESIDENTIAL									
New Residential House: i.e. detached, semi detached, condo, townhouse etc. *(DC charges applicable)*	220	-58%	116	353	-5%	91,297,015	527	373	105,808,325
Residential House Additions, Alterations, Demolitions: i.e. detached, semi detached, condo, townhouse etc.	208	3%	65	218	34%	7,750,414	201	163	3,994,806
Residential Multi Storey: i.e. apartments, condo etc.	2	100%	2	3	200%	83,639,060	1	1	2,788,000
Minor Residential: i.e. decks, sheds, garages etc.	315	-13%	60	331	1%	9,364,674	360	329	7,258,988
Accessory Apartment: i.e. 9.8 OFC, OBC	181	7%	53	178	19%	7,491,155	169	149	6,524,471
Sub-Total	**926**	**-26%**	**296**	**1083**	**7%**	**199,542,318**	**1,258**	**1015**	**126,374,590**
COMMERICAL									
Assembly Permit: i.e. community buildings, large restaurants etc.	14	-33%	8	10	-50%	19,571,400	21	20	12,123,780
Business & Personal Service: i.e. offices, hair salons etc.	17	13%	4	15	-6%	11,835,900	15	16	1,750,520
Detention, Care & Treatment: i.e. hospitals, nursing homes etc.	2	100%	0	2	0%	69,763	1	2	1,695,779
Minor Non-Residential: i.e. portable classrooms, temporary tents etc.	60	-22%	14	57	-19%	7,277,292	77	70	3,177,460
Mercantile: i.e. retail, market, shopping mall etc.	25	-50%	7	22	-53%	6,103,210	50	47	7,251,544
Change of Use: i.e. office to private school	0	0%	0	0	0%	0	0	0	0
Sign Permit	38	-47%	3	41	-41%	649,081	72	69	1,165,320
Sub-Total	**156**	**-34%**	**36**	**147**	**-34%**	**45,506,646**	**236**	**224**	**27,164,403**
INDUSTRIAL									
Industrial Permit: i.e. manufacturing building, parking garage etc.	32	-22%	15	25	-49%	61,621,826	41	49	178,948,676
Sub-Total	**32**	**-22%**	**15**	**25**	**-49%**	**61,621,826**	**41**	**49**	**178,948,676**
SITE SERVICING									
Site Servicing: i.e. underground sewer, water and drainage	13	8%	8	8	-38%	1,538,972	12	13	16,928,151
Sub-Total	**13**	**8%**	**8**	**8**	**-38%**	**1,538,972**	**12**	**13**	**16,928,151**
TOTAL	**1,127**	**-27%**	**355**	**1,263**	**-3%**	**308,209,762**	**1,547**	**1,301**	**349,415,820**

Town of Ajax Report

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Steven McReelis, Manager, Building Approvals & Chief Building Official
Report #:	PDS-2023-09
Subject:	**Development Charge Deferral Amending Agreement – 35-37 Kings Crescent**
Ward(s):	3
Date of Meeting:	March 20, 2023
Reference:	Town of Ajax By-law 50-2018 15 Jun 20 GGC - Development Charge Deferral Agreement – 35-37 Kings Crescent

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Recommendation:

That the Development Charge Deferral Amending Agreement for 35-37 Kings Crescent (ATT-1) be approved.

1. Background:

The Salvation Army has approval to construct an 1,824.7 square metre, two-storey building that is comprised of the following uses: place of worship, food bank, kitchen/dining area, staff offices and emergency case basis shelter services.

The property is assessed as Exempt-Charitable organization by the Municipal Property Assessment Corporation (MPAC), which is not exempt from development charge payments under the Town's Development Charge By-law. Development charge payments are calculated and due at the time of the first building permit issuance. The Salvation Army's intent is to apply to MPAC to have the assessment changed to a 'place of worship,' which would exempt them from paying development charges. For MPAC to assess the property and determine what classification would apply, the building must be constructed.

In order to facilitate the Salvation Army's Application to MPAC to request that the assessment for the lands change from a 'charitable organization' to a 'place of worship', the Town agreed on June 15th, 2020, to enter into a Development Charge Deferral Agreement, pending a final assessment decision from MPAC.

2. Discussion:

Subsection 9(3) of the Town's Development Charge By-law 50-2018 permits an owner and the Town to enter into an agreement to provide for the payment of development charges later than the issuance of a building permit. The Salvation Army proposed an agreement pursuant to Section 27 of the Development Charges Act, 1997, S.O. 1997, that consents to defer the calculation and payment of the development charges pending completion of an assessment of the new building by MPAC.

On June 15th, 2020, Council endorsed an agreement with the Salvation Army that would defer the payment of the development charges for a period of two years from the date that the first building permit is issued. The first building permit was issued on February 11th, 2021, meaning that the deferral agreement expired on February 11th, 2023.

Due to construction delays related to the pandemic, construction of the building was not able to be completed within the two-year period, and the Salvation Army has requested an extension to the deferral agreement. The attached amending agreement will revise the development charge payment due date agreement to the earliest of 30 days after an assessment decision is rendered, or 12 months from the date that occupancy of the building is granted. The amending agreement also stipulates that the Salvation Army make a request to MPAC within fourteen days of the date of the granting of occupancy.

3. Financial Implications:

The development charges payable for the Salvation Army development, under its current MPAC assessment class of Exempt-Charitable Organization, is $104,690.41.

The Salvation Army's intention is to operate the facility as a place of worship, which is currently exempt from paying development charges under Development Charge By-Law 50-2018. To provide the Salvation Army an opportunity to make an application to MPAC to change the exemption from taxation of the Lands from charitable institution to a place of worship, the Town agreed to enter into the DC deferral agreement, pending a final assessment decision.

If the Salvation Army are not exempted from the development charges payment, or if no decision has been rendered before the expiry of the deferral period, they will be responsible for paying the full development charge amount of $104,690.41 along with interest calculated at the Bank of Canada prime rate in effect on the date of issuance of the building permit plus 2% per annum from the permit issuance date. As of December 2022 approximately $5,000 in interest has been calculated. The payment of the development charges will occur over three equal installments.

4. Communication Issues:

None

5. Relationship to the Strategic Plan 2018-2022:

This report aligns with the following areas of the Strategic Plan:

Focus Area: Connecting our Community
Goal: 4. Creating opportunities to foster a welcoming and inclusive community.

Focus Area: Investing in our Community
Goal: 2. Encouraging and supporting strategic land use development.

6. Conclusion:

This Development Charge Deferral Amending Agreement will allow the Salvation Army to complete the construction of the building, while also allowing the Salvation Army the opportunity to make an application to MPAC for an assessment of the new building.

7. Attachments:

ATT-1: Development Charge Deferral Amending Agreement

Prepared by:

Steven McReelis – Manager, Building Approvals & Chief Building Official
Submitted by:

Geoff Romanowski – Director, Planning & Development Services

Approved by:

Shane Baker – Chief Administrative Officer

AMENDING DEFERRAL AGREEMENT made this 10th day of February, 2023.

BETWEEN:

THE CORPORATION OF THE TOWN OF AJAX

(hereinafter referred to as the "Town")

OF THE FIRST PART,

- and-

THE GOVERNING COUNCIL OF THE SALVATION ARMY IN CANADA

(hereinafter referred to collectively as the "Owner")

OF THE SECOND PART.

WHEREAS the Owner herein is the registered owner of the lands hereinafter defined as the Lands;

AND WHEREAS the Owner and the Town entered into a Development Charge Deferral Agreement dated May 1, 2021 (the "Deferral Agreement") with respect to the payment of development charges as a result of the development of the Lands pursuant to File No. SP16/18;

AND WHEREAS the parties hereto have agreed to amend the Deferral Agreement to provide for the changes as hereinafter set out.

NOW THEREFORE this Agreement witnesseth that in consideration of mutual benefits the Parties hereto agree as follows:

1. In this Agreement:

   "Lands" mean the lands described as:

   Block B Plan 510, Town of Ajax Regional Municipality of Durham, PIN

   26456-0007 (LT).

2. The actual amount of development charges payable for the development calculated pursuant to paragraph 2 (b) of the Deferral Agreement is $104,690.41.

3. Paragraph 1 (c) is hereby deleted and the following substituted therefore:
   The Town agrees that it will defer any obligation to pay such development charges for a period of twelve (12) months from the date the Town issues an occupancy permit for the Proposed Development (the "Deferral Period"), subject to payment as set out in paragraph 2(b) in the event an Assessment Decision is rendered prior to the twelve (12) months, in order to permit the Owner the opportunity to make application under the Assessment Act to change the exemption from taxation of the Lands from charitable Institution to a place of worship (the "Exemption").
   The Owner agrees to request the Exemption within fourteen (14) days of the date of the issuance of the occupancy permit and deliver evidence of such request to the Town within the fourteen (14) day period.

4. Paragraph 2 (b) of the Deferral Agreement is hereby deleted and the following substituted therefore:
"(b) In the event that the result of such Assessment Decision is that the Owner does not successfully secure an Exemption from taxation of the Lands to a place of worship or part of the Lands or in the event that no such Assessment Decision is rendered on or before the expiry of the Deferral Period, the Owner agrees that it will pay development charges in three equal annual instalments of $34,896.80 together with interest commencing on the 30th day after the Assessment Decision is rendered or the expiry of the Deferral Period, whichever is first to occur, and on each anniversary of the first instalment until the development charges in the amount of $104,690.41 together with interest have been paid in full. Annual interest shall be calculated and paid on the outstanding balance from time to time with each instalment at the Bank of Canada prime rate as at the date of FBP plus 2% from the date of the FBP.

5. This Agreement may be registered by the Town against the title to the Lands and at the cost of the Owner.

6. Time shall be of the essence of this Agreement and each of its provisions.

7. Except as specifically amended hereby the parties hereto do in all respects ratify and confirm the provisions of the Deferral Agreement.

8. This Agreement shall be binding upon and enure to the benefit of each of the parties and their respective successors and assigns.

9. The Owner agrees to pay to the Town the legal costs incurred by the Town in connection with the preparation and registration of this Agreement in the amount of $977.40 and to pay to the Town the sum of $82.00 for the registration fee.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF the parties have signed this Agreement by the hands of their respective officers duly authorized in that behalf as of the date set out above.

THE CORPORATION OF THE TOWN OF AJAX

Per: _____
Name: Shaun Collier
Title: Mayor

Per:_____
Name: Jason McWilliam
Title: Manager of Legislative Services/Deputy Clerk

We have authority to bind the Corporation.

THE GOVERNING COUNCIL OF THE SALVATION ARMY IN CANADA

Per:_____
Name:
Title: Authorized Signing Officer

Per:_____
Name:
Title: Authorized Signing Office

We have the authority to bind the Corporation.

Town of Ajax Report

Report To:	General Government Committee
Prepared By:	Cameron Richardson, Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change
Report #:	PDS-2023-05
Subject:	**Environmental Sustainability Projects and Programs – Status Update**
Ward(s):	All
Date of Meeting:	March 20, 2023
Reference:	Council – March 28, 2022 (Environmental Sustainability Projects and Programs – Status Update – PDS-2022-09) GGC – March 8, 2021 (Environmental Sustainability Projects and Programs – Status Update – PDS-2021-05)

Recommendation:

1. **That the report entitled "Environmental Sustainability Projects and Programs – Status Update" be received for information.**

1. Background:

The Town of Ajax has always taken a proactive, environment-first approach by adopting and implementing plans and policies that integrate climate change mitigation and adaptation into land use planning, corporate initiatives, and daily operations. This approach is evident in several initiatives including, but not limited to, Ajax's Official Plan policies, Climate Risk & Resiliency Plan and Implementation Strategy, Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics, and Textile Diversion Program.

In September 2019, the Town of Ajax declared a climate emergency to acknowledge the impacts of climate change and reaffirm its commitment to proactively mitigating and adapting to those impacts wherever possible through the Town's continued leadership, advocacy, and intergovernmental partnerships.

2. Discussion:

The Town of Ajax continues to demonstrate leadership in environmental sustainability by developing and implementing a diverse range of projects and programs that addresses air quality, waste management, natural cover, water quality, and climate change. These projects and programs require cross-collaboration across all divisions at the Town of Ajax and with external stakeholders.

The following information provides an update on several of the projects and programs within the Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change portfolio, with specific focus on 2023/2024 implementation priorities.

2.1 Ajax Climate Risk & Resiliency Plan, 2019 (ACRRP)

The ACRRP and associated Implementation Strategy was approved by Council in June 2019. The purpose of the ACRRP is to provide a strategic framework to address current and future climate change risks. The ACRRP Implementation Progress Report (PDS-2022-09) provided a detailed update on implementation progress to February 2022.

Staff will continue to focus on delivering priorities identified in the Implementation Strategy. In 2022, implementation was focused on wetland creation and restoration, urban forest analysis, and initiating the Ajax SNAP. In 2023/2024, immediate efforts will be focused on the following identified priorities:

a) Wetland Creation and Restoration

Objective 6 of the ACRRP is to protect, restore and expand natural heritage systems across the Town to support biodiversity and improve overall resiliency to climate change impacts. In 2022, the Town of Ajax, in partnership with Toronto and Region Conservation Authority (TRCA), Region of Durham, and Ducks Unlimited Canada, completed the Kerrison Wetland Restoration Project. The wetland restoration project created and enhanced approximately 3 hectares (7 acres) of wetland habitat, decommissioned two old farm ponds and associated infrastructure, restored and stabilized stream bank erosion, re-aligned and reconstructed the Carruthers Creek multi-use trail, and managed populations of invasive species. Thousands of native trees and shrubs were planted across 6 hectares (15 acres) of riparian habitat to improve biodiversity, increase natural cover and habitat for local wildlife, and enhance the greenspace for the community. Tree fencing was installed around the new planting areas to deter deer browsing and increase survival rates of the new plantings. In 2023, ongoing invasive species management and native tree/shrub plantings will occur. The Kerrison Wetland Restoration Project garnered significant positive media coverage.

In 2023, staff will continue to identify and apply to funding opportunities to support wetland creation and restoration projects already identified across Ajax.

b) Ajax Sustainable Neighbourhood Action Plan

Objective 3 of the ACRRP is to implement supporting plans, programs, and policies to manage human health impacts resulting from climate change. To support this objective, the ACRRP identifies implementation priorities associated with reducing heat stress related to the urban heat island effect as well as addressing urban flood risks through education and mitigation projects. The Ajax Sustainable Neighbourhood Action Program (Ajax SNAP) is a neighbourhood-scale community retrofit and engagement program that involves the community and stakeholders in identifying and addressing multiple objectives related to stormwater management, water conservation, energy conservation, and natural heritage.

In partnership with the Region of Durham and TRCA, staff completed an in-depth analysis to select a candidate neighbourhood for SNAP implementation as detailed in Report PDS-2022-25. The Ajax SNAP was officially launched in November 2022 and will be completed by the end of 2023.

c) Salt Vulnerable Areas Assessment

Objective 6 of the ACRRP is to protect, restore and expand natural heritage systems across the Town to support biodiversity and improve overall resiliency to climate change impacts. To achieve this objective, the ACRRP identifies the need to reduce the negative impacts on water quality, wildlife, and vegetation that road salt use can have. In 2022, staff participated on TRCA's Water Quality Advisory Group to identify and scope a Salt Vulnerable Area (SVA) assessment. In 2023, staff will continue to support our Conservation Authority partners to better identify and assess local factors and sources affecting stream chloride concentrations. This SVA assessment will look at the use of road salts as well as land use, seasonal weather patterns, groundwater sources, and climate change impacts and is expected to be completed by the end of 2023. Once complete, this detailed assessment will help to develop a modelling tool that will identify and prioritize SVAs as well as identify potential mitigation opportunities.

d) Urban Forest

Objective 5 of the ACRRP is to ensure that naturalized urban areas within the Town are enhanced to be resilient to climate change and support biodiversity. The management of Ajax's urban forest is a key component of achieving this objective. In July 2021, Town of Ajax joined the Durham Region-wide Local Enhancement and Appreciation of Forests (LEAF) program to encourage and incentivize Ajax residents to plant trees on their private property. The program will meet the target of planting 55 trees in Ajax annually.

Led by the Town's Manager of Environmental Services, several urban forest initiatives are identified as a priority in 2023 and beyond. In 2022, in partnership with TRCA, Town of Ajax initiated an Urban Forest Technical Study. The purpose of the study is to reassess the structure and function of the urban forest compared to the data collected in 2009 and to provide management recommendations for enhancing the sustainability of both the urban forest and the community. This technical study will help inform a comprehensive update to the Urban Forest Management Plan to provide strategic guidance for the short-, mid-, and long-term management of trees and the benefit they provide to the Town. The update to the Urban Forest Management Plan will be initiated in 2023.

Achieving the objectives identified in the ACRRP will require the Town's ongoing commitment and leadership to climate change mitigation and adaptation. An annual progress report to Council will highlight successes and will provide a progress update for each identified action.

2.2 Energy

Developing a culture of energy conservation and reducing the demand for energy production to minimize greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions is a priority for the Town of Ajax. The Integrated Community Sustainability Plan (ICSP) was completed in 2013 to serve as a corporate and community climate change mitigation plan. Since that time, the Town has developed and endorsed several additional plans that more specifically guide corporate and community climate change mitigation actions. These plans include the Durham Community Energy Plan, the 2019 Corporate Energy Conservation and Demand Management Plan, and the Ajax Green Standard. Several upcoming plans and initiatives will help the Town in achieving GHG emission reductions corporately and across the community as its population continues to grow. These initiatives include sector-specific mitigation plans such as the upcoming Green Fleet Strategy (to be initiated in 2023), District Energy Feasibility Study (proposed for 2025), and the 2024 update to the Corporate Energy Conservation and Demand Management Plan (to be initiated in 2023). These existing and proposed mitigation plans have superseded the ICSP.

a) GHG Emissions Reduction Targets

In April 2021, Town of Ajax updated the corporate GHG emission reduction targets through a Motion of Council. The updated corporate reduction targets are as follows:

- 20% GHG emissions reduction by 2025, below 2019 levels;
- 40% GHG emissions reduction by 2030, below 2019 levels;
- 100% GHG emissions reduction by 2050, below 2019 levels.

The Town's corporate GHG emissions reduction targets will be reflected in the 2024 update to the Energy Conservation and Demand Management Plan as well as the Green Fleet Strategy.

As part of the motion, Ajax Council also endorsed the Region of Durham's updated community GHG emissions reduction targets. The Region's community GHG emissions reduction targets are as follows:

- 10% GHG emissions reduction by 2025, below 2019 levels;
- 30% GHG emissions reduction by 2030, below 2019 levels;
- 100% GHG emissions reduction by 2050, below 2019 levels.

Town staff will continue to lead and support initiatives with the goal of reducing community GHG emissions which includes:

- Implementing the Ajax Green Standard for new development and redevelopment within the Town (See Section 2.3 of this report for more information);
- Completing a District Energy Feasibility Study to identify the potential for renewable district energy in Ajax;
- Supporting the Durham Greener Homes existing buildings retrofit program, a Durham Region-led initiative launched in 2022;
- Supporting the Durham Zero Emission Vehicle Joint Venture Program (See Section 2.2.c of this report for more information);
- Coordinating land-use planning and policies for sustainable growth, including during the upcoming Official Plan review;
- Ongoing education and outreach initiatives targeted to a wide range of stakeholders including the Ajax SNAP (see Section 2.1.b and 2.6 of this report for more information).

b) Cities Race to Zero Pledge

In August 2021, the Town of Ajax became the first municipality in Durham Region to pledge and join the *Cities Race to Zero*, a global initiative to rally leadership and action to create a more inclusive, resilient, and decarbonized economy. As part of the initiative, Town of Ajax pledged to recognize the global climate emergency, commit to keeping global warming below the targets set in the Paris Agreement, commit to inclusive climate action, and commit to disclosing the Town's environmental impact on the CDP platform annually starting in 2022.

c) Zero Emission Vehicle Joint Venture Program

Zero emission vehicles are a key action needed to meet climate change and GHG reduction commitments.

Town of Ajax staff, in partnership with Durham Region, Oshawa Power & Utilities Corporation, and Elexicon, will continue to support delivery of the NRCan-funded Zero Emission Vehicle Awareness Initiative. The initiative commenced in 2021 and is a comprehensive outreach

campaign, targeted at Durham Region residents, to increase zero emission vehicle adoption. In September 2022, as part of the initiative, Town of Ajax co-hosted an electric vehicle (EV) lunch-and-learn at Audley Recreation Centre, in partnership with the Ajax-Pickering Board of Trade. The event offered test drives of EVs, presentations, and an opportunity to speak with EV experts.

2.3 Ajax Green Standard (AGS)

The AGS, formerly known as the Green Development and Environmental Design Guidelines (GDEDG), was approved at the April 2022 Community Affairs and Planning Committee meeting (Report PDS-2022-11). The AGS is required for all new Site Plan and/or Draft Plan of Subdivision applications submitted on or after May 1, 2022. Detailed monitoring and implementation tracking to measure the effectiveness of the AGS, including potential incentives, will continue to address any unforeseen difficulties and improve the implementation process in a timely manner. To incorporate emerging trends and new technologies, the AGS will undergo a comprehensive update every three (3) to five (5) years.

In 2023, Town staff will participate in a Region-led initiative to work collaboratively with municipalities, development industry stakeholders, and utilities to identify and implement a Region-wide incentive program to encourage the development industry to build to higher standards as identified in the AGS.

2.4 Great Lakes Initiatives

In the Town of Ajax, the health of the community relies heavily on protecting and enhancing a high-quality Great Lakes ecosystem, and its finite water resources for drinking water and recreational purposes. The Town's Official Plan identifies the goal of encouraging and supporting timely, effective actions by senior governments, the International Joint Commission (IJC), and others to improve and restore the quality of Lake Ontario and the other Great Lakes. This goal is vital to address recurring and emerging concerns such as nutrients, invasive species, chemical contaminants, and algal growth.

To achieve this goal, the Town of Ajax provides technical and strategic advice on several committees associated with Great Lakes initiatives including the:

- IJC's Great Lakes – St. Lawrence River Adaptive Management (GLAM) Committee to support ongoing evaluation of the regulation of water levels and flows.
- Great Lakes Executive Committee (GLEC) to help coordinate and implement the programs and other measures undertaken to achieve the purpose of the Great Lakes Water Quality Agreement.
    - In 2022, staff provided input to support the development of the 2023-2027 Lake Ontario Lakewide Action and Management Plan (LAMP);
- Great Lakes and St. Lawrence Cities Initiative (GLSCI) to advance the protection and restoration of the Great Lakes and St. Lawrence River.
    - This includes supporting the Mayor, as required, on the Mayors Advisory Council on Coastal Resilience. This advisory council will assess challenges facing municipal governments and identify possible solutions related to coastal erosion, flooding, high water levels, and severe weather events;
    - In 2022, staff participated in the development of a detailed report entitled *An Assessment of Coastal Resilience in Great Lakes Communities* led by the University of Michigan School for Environment and Sustainability;

- In June 2022, staff attended the GLSLCI Annual conference in St. Catherines, ON where Cameron Richardson, Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change was awarded the Barb Hodgins Award which recognizes a municipal staff individual who has demonstrated notable efforts in sustainability and other GLSLCI strategic priority areas.

In addition to providing expertise to the committees listed above, the Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change team completed the following in 2022:

- In March 2022, staff met with the MECP's York Region Wastewater Advisory Panel to reiterate the Town's position on the York Region Waste Water Act.
- In November 2022, submitted an official response to the Province of Ontario's proposed *Supporting Growth and Housing in York and Durham Regions Act, 2021* and *Report of the York Region Wastewater Advisory Panel* as part of *Bill 23 – More Homes Built Faster Act, 2022* consultation.

2.5 Waste

The Town of Ajax has proactively introduced policies and taken leadership roles related to environmental stewardship and waste diversion including a Green Event policy, corporate ban on single use plastics, and a textile diversion program.

The Town coordinates community sustainability events and outreach programs to encourage proper waste education and urban green living. All waste-related programs and projects align with the Town's strategic priorities as well as with the Region of Durham's Long-term Waste Management Plan 2021-2040.

a) Corporate Ban on Single Use Plastics

In March 2020, Council approved the *Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics Implementation Plan* and corresponding actions. The corporate ban is being implemented in five distinct phases, each of which has key milestones to monitor implementation and success. In 2022, actions implemented include:

- Hosted a webinar, in partnership with A Greener Future, on how to reduce waste and the use of single-use plastics at home and at work;
- Connected with Mind Your Plastic, a Canadian charitable organization, to discuss how municipalities across Canada can work towards banning single-use plastics in daily operations with Ajax being part of a case study;
- Worked with Purchasing to tender a contract for a Vendor of Record for compostable service ware;
- Completed research and best practices of ensuring community compliance and reported to Council in March 2023 (PDS-2023-05) with recommendations for improving external compliance;
- Continued to review and monitor policy proposals and updates released by both the Federal and Provincial government related to single-use plastics and extended producer responsibility;
- Developed and launched the new Single-Use Plastics website to educate permit-holders, community partners, local businesses, and residents on how to voluntarily reduce their plastics consumption.

Starting in 2023, staff focus will be to complete any remaining tasks identified in the five-phase implementation plan including:

- Continuing to review and monitor policy proposals and updates released by both the Federal and Provincial government related to single use plastics and extended producer responsibility;
- Continuing to execute a public education campaign for permit-holders, community partners, local businesses, and residents to voluntarily reduce their plastics consumption. This includes partnering with Mind Your Plastic to develop and launch an interactive toolkit and co-host workshops in 2023;
- Incorporating a standardized approach to engage and promote both voluntary reduction of single-use plastics and the use of appropriate alternatives to permit applicants.

b) Textile Diversion Program

In May 2021, Council approved the *Textile Diversion Program* and corresponding actions. The textile diversion program is being implemented in five distinct phases, each of which has key milestones to monitor implementation and success. In 2022, actions implemented include:

- Endorsing a Council Charter on Textile Waste Diversion and subsequent communications campaign;
- Updating the dedicated Textile Waste Diversion webpage that was launched in 2021;
- Hosting a Staff Textile Recycling Collection that collected over 400 pounds of gently used textiles.

In 2023, staff focus will be to complete the remaining tasks identified in *Phase I, II and III.* These phases prioritize the continued engagement and education of a large range of stakeholders including residents, businesses, Town staff, and charitable textile collection organizations.

2.6 Community Engagement and Education

Staff will continue to engage and educate all stakeholders in our community to foster active ownership of our natural spaces and the adoption of sustainability practices. The addition of two Sustainability Intern positions to the Environmental Sustainability and Climate Change team in 2022 has resulted in the team providing more community engagement opportunities to the public. In addition to the engagement and education priorities identified above, priority will be to implement the following in 2023:

a) Environmental Sustainability Website Updates and Social Media

Many sustainability initiatives undertaken by the Town of Ajax are highlighted on the Town's Environmental Sustainability webpage and in social media content. In 2022, the Environmental Sustainability website was updated to ensure current and consistent messaging including dedicated information for the Corporate Ban on Single-Use Plastics, Kerrison Wetland Restoration Project, and the Ajax SNAP. The website will continue to be refined, developed, and updated as necessary.

b) Ajax Youth Greening Pilot Program

In 2023, the Ajax Youth Greening Pilot Project will be launched by TRCA with support from the Ajax Partnership Fund. This project will engage youth in action-based greening events to help protect, enhance, and restore natural infrastructure and help create more sustainable

communities. The project will engage 160 youth in 10 greening events in 2023 to plant 1000 native trees, shrubs, and wildflowers.

c) Stewardship Activities

Every year, Town of Ajax staff plan virtual and in-person stewardship activities to engage our community and local stakeholders. In 2023, the annual Green Living Days will celebrate Earth Day. Several departments across the organization will be hosting Green Living Days events and programs including a public tree planting event, litter clean us, compost giveaway, virtual and in-person workshops, and promotion of the SunnyTOA Eco Team volunteer program. Several of these activities will support the No Mow May Motion of Council that was adopted in January 2023.

2.7 External Committees

In addition to the committees identified in Section 2.4, the Planning Policy & Research and Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change teams within Planning & Development Services represents the Town of Ajax to provide technical and strategic advice on several external committees related to sustainability including the:

- Carruthers Creek Watershed Plan Implementation Advisory Group;
- OPG Community Advisory Committee;
- Duffin Creek Water Pollution Control Plant Advisory Committee;
- Durham Community Climate Adaptation Plan Steering Committee and associated Working Groups (Flooding, Human Health, Food Security, Building and Electrical, and Natural Environment);
- Durham Community Energy Plan working groups (Retrofit Task Force, Governance Task Force);
- Cross-Durham Food Systems Report Card Roundtable

2.8 Environmental Planner

In December 2022, the new Environmental Planner position was filled to help advance the sustainability portfolio by implementing the AGS, supporting the Town's climate change policy development (including the identification and implementation of adaptation and mitigation initiatives), supporting the review of the Town's Official Plan (with emphasis on natural heritage, watershed planning, air quality, water quality, and GHG emissions), and advancing the Town's reputation as a leader in environmental sustainability as identified in the Town's Strategic Plan.

2.9 Projects and Initiatives - 2024 and Beyond

Some projects and initiatives within the Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change portfolio have already been identified as priorities for 2024 and beyond. These priorities include:

- Implementation of mid- to long-term priority actions identified in the ACRRP Implementation Plan;
- Initiation of the five-year update to the ACRRP to incorporate emerging trends and identified climate risks;

- Implementation of remaining actions identified in the Corporate Ban on Single Use Plastics and Textile Diversion Program; and,
- Updating the Energy Conservation Demand Management Plan in 2024 as required under the *Electricity Act*

3. Financial Implications:

There are no financial implications associated with the approval of this report.

4. Communication Issues:

Environmental sustainability and climate change related work plans will require substantial communication to both internal and external stakeholders. The Town will leverage its Corporate Communications group to help educate and engage staff on sustainability practices and responsibilities. Externally, staff will focus on the promotion of the Town's leadership, sustainability undertakings, and successes to all relevant stakeholders including residents, community partners, local businesses, and other levels of government.

In addition to the required reporting associated with some of the projects described above, the Supervisor of Environmental Sustainability & Climate Change will continue to provide an annual update to the Senior Management Team.

5. Relationship to the Strategic Plan:

This report aligns with the following sections of the 2018-2022 Strategic Plan – Stronger Together:

Focus Area:	Leading our Community
Goal:	Advocating for intergovernmental matters important to our community.
Action:	Continue to advocate for tertiary treatment at the Duffin Creek Water Pollution Control Plant

Focus Area:	Leading our Community
Goal:	Providing continued leadership in environmental sustainability
Action:	Implement actions and recommendations in the Ajax Climate Risk & Resiliency Plan
Action:	Update the Energy Conservation Demand Management Plan and continue to invest in energy efficiency upgrades to Town-owned infrastructure
Action:	Develop Green Development and Environmental Design Guidelines to encourage sustainable infrastructure and living
Action:	Increase community sustainability events and outreach to encourage proper waste education and urban green living

6. Conclusion:

The projects and programs described above are not an exhaustive list of all sustainability-related initiatives within the Town. Several other sustainability initiatives are being led by other departments within the Town of Ajax. This includes, but is not limited to, urban forest management, invasive species management, stormwater infrastructure improvements, active

transportation projects, EV fleet procurement and charging infrastructure, permeable parking lots, and facility energy retrofits.

The Town of Ajax will continue to exemplify strong leadership and advocacy to fulfill our vision of becoming a sustainable community. Cross-collaboration between all departments, other municipalities, and government partners will be required to ensure that the Town of Ajax pro-actively mitigates and adapts to the expected impacts of climate change.

Attachments:

N/A

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